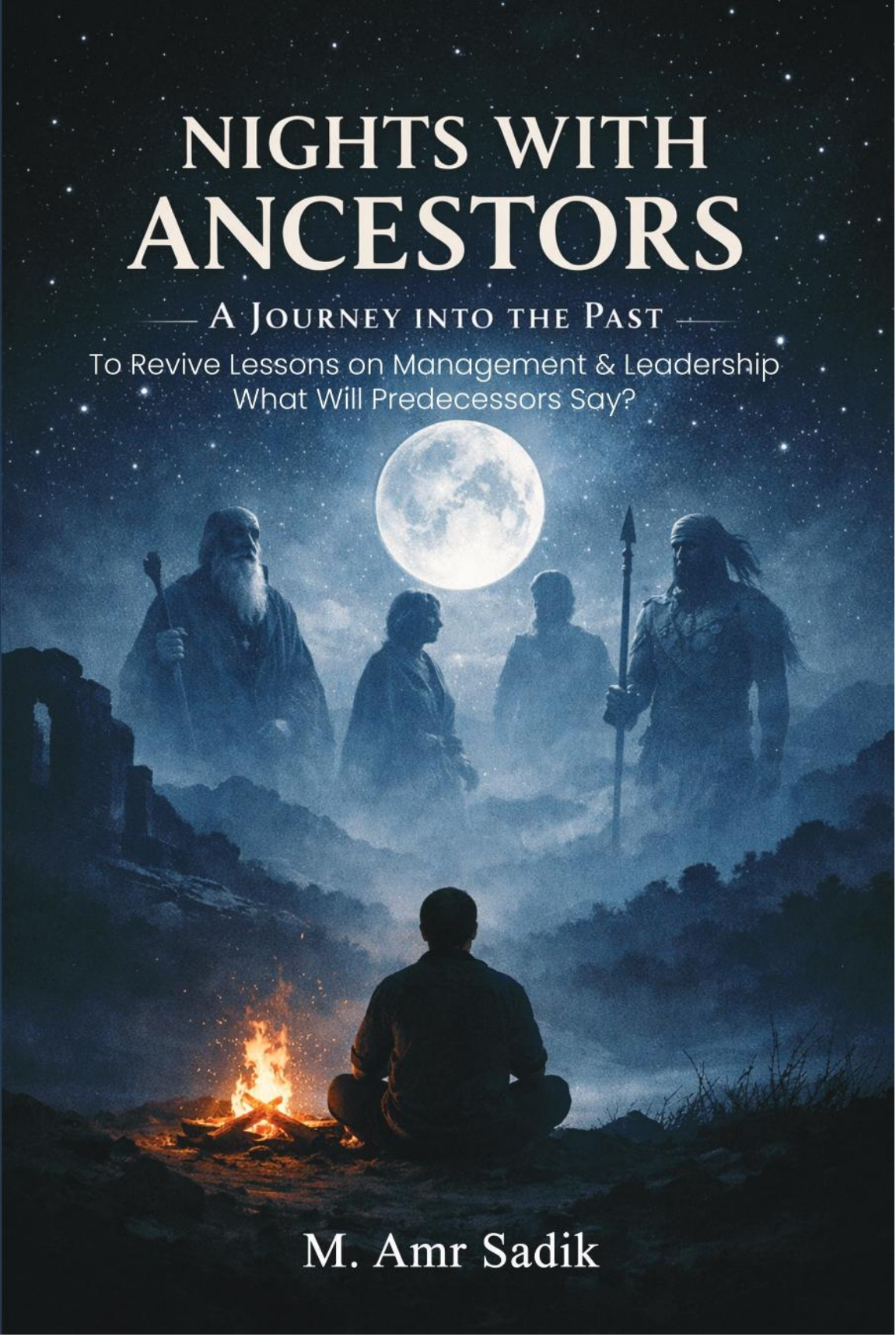
NIGHTS WITH ANCESTORS

A Journey into the Past

To Revive Lessons on Management & Leadership
What Will Predecessors Say?



M. Amr Sadik

Nights with Ancestors
A Journey Into The Past

M. Amr Sadik



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Author's Note

Like most of the veterans in their fields, I started my HR career thirty or more years ago, from the very bottomup, but I was quite fortunate to get the chance fast in my early years, and also understood that HR, or Personnel in that time, is not about paperwork, policing people, and/or corrective measures. It is about the happiness of the employees.

Seriously, I was so lucky to work with a very competent and creative Swiss management team, failure or excuses were not in their business dictionary, but detailed planning, continuous learning, communication and reading remained in it.

Working with such great managers and leaders I have I have learnt that I should not stop learning and keep thinking out of the box.

However, I do remember my first interview in the early eighties, after being promoted to the designation of Assistant Personnel Manager in my small hotel with the Director of Personnel & Training for Middle East and Africa of Sheraton Corporation. When he asked the usual question: "Where do you see yourself with us?" I spontaneously replied; "Taking up your position." I was very ambitious and had self-confidence, but I was not hired. However, I was hired in the late eighties during the pre-opening of one of their luxury hotels as the Training Manager and was subsequently promoted to the Director of Human Resources.

*****

When I first decided to come up with this book, I was asking myself what I should talk about, with whom, and why I should do that. So, probably I was very curious to know different views and wanted to gain a deeper understanding of how the ancestors' experiences shaped their own identity.

This is not an ordinary book.

I dreamed that I had travelled through time to the past to talk with our ancestors in an event full of pragmatic dialogue and wisdom in casual, breathtaking conversations. So, we will not be addressing them with any title, but only with their first names, as this is casual and friendly conversation.

It was not that easy to select whom I'm going to talk with, as the history of our ancestors is full of great people, be it a prince, king, queen, military leader, philosopher, or even scientist.

Therefore, I decided to randomly select from each corner of the world, from east to west, and from north to south, in an attempt to know what makes a great leader, and how things can be done.

We will be talking about different things, different issues, different concepts from their own perspectives.

Enjoy the journey!

***

Introduction

*A*t the outset, two main questions came to my mind while writing this book: ***What is Management? and What is Leadership?***

To answer those questions through our discussions with the ancestors, we need primarily to understand ***why management fails***. And ***why leaders fail?***

*****

Management as we know it today is struggling to do the job it was intended to do. But we can also see evidence of a creeping disenchantment with management as a discipline.

- Management as a profession is not well respected.
- Employees are unhappy with their managers.
- There are no positive role models.

Management is a universal phenomenon. It is a very popular and widely used term. All organizations — business, political, cultural or social are involved in management because it is the management which helps and directs the various efforts towards a definite purpose.

According to ***Harold Koontz***, Management is the art of getting things done through and with the people in formally organized groups. It is the art of creating an environment in which people can perform individually and can cooperate towards the attainment of group goals.

According to ***F.W. Taylor***, Management is the art of knowing what to do, when to do and seeing that it is done in the best and cheapest way.

Management is a purposive activity. It is something that directs group efforts towards the attainment of certain pre-determined goals.

Management is the process of working with and through others to effectively achieve the goals of the organization, by efficiently using limited resources in the changing world. Of course, these goals may vary from one enterprise to another. E.g.: For one enterprise, it may be the launching of new products by conducting market surveys ,and for another it may be profit maximization by minimizing cost.

Management involves creating an internal environment. It is the management which puts into use the various factors of production. Therefore, it is the responsibility of management to create such conditions which are conducive to maximum efforts so that people are able to perform their tasks efficiently and effectively. It includes ensuring the availability of raw materials, determination of wages and salaries, formulation of rules & regulations, etc.

Therefore, we can say that good management includes both being effective and efficient.

- Being effective means doing the appropriate task i.e., fitting the square pegs in square holes and the round pegs in round holes.
- Being efficient means doing the task correctly, at the least possible cost, with minimum wastage of resources.

The Corruption of Management

Where did management go wrong?

We need to rethink management, we need to help executives figure out the best way to manage, and we need to help employees take some responsibility to get the managers they deserve. We don't talk about financial corruption; that is obvious. Our concentration on Intellectual corruption, administrative corruption and corruption in implementing procedures.

For example, public sector organizations are under pressure to adopt private sector tools to sustain legitimacy despite uncertainty about the compatibility of the techniques with this context. So, we need a clear definition of management. Management can be defined in detail in the following categories:



As a process, management refers to a series of interrelated functions. It is the process by which management creates, operates and directs purposive organization through systematic, coordinated and cooperated human efforts.

According to **George R. Terry**, Management is a distinct process consisting of planning, organizing, actuating and controlling, performed to determine and accomplish stated objectives by the use of human beings and other resources.

As a process, management consists of three aspects:

- **Management is a social process :** Since the human factor is most important among the other factors, management is concerned with developing relationship among people. It is the duty of management to make interaction between people — productive and useful for obtaining organizational goals.
- **Management is an integrating process :** Management undertakes the job of bringing together human, physical and financial resources so as to achieve organizational purpose. Therefore, it is an important function to bring harmony between various factors.
- **Management is a continuous process** : It is a never-ending process. It is concerned with constantly identifying the problems and solving them by taking adequate steps. It is an ongoing process.

Management is also an activity because a manager is one who accomplishes the objectives by directing the efforts of others.

According to Koontz, Management is what a manager does. Management as an activity includes:

- **Informational activities :** In the functioning of a business enterprise, the manager constantly has to receive and give information orally or in writing. A communication link has to be maintained with subordinates as well as superiors for the effective functioning of an enterprise.
- **Decisional activities :** Practically all types of managerial activities are based on one or the other types of decisions. Therefore, managers are continuously involved in decisions

of different kinds since the decision made by one manager becomes the basis of action to be taken by other managers.

- **Inter-personal activities :** Management involves achieving goals through people. Therefore, managers have to interact with superiors as well as sub-ordinates. They must maintain good relations with them. The inter-personal activities include interacting with the sub-ordinates and taking care of the problem. (E.g., Bonuses to be given to the sub-ordinates).

Management as a discipline refers to that branch of knowledge which is connected to the study of principles & practices of basic administration. It specifies a certain code of conduct to be followed by the manager & also various methods for managing resources efficiently.

Management as a discipline specifies a certain code of conduct for managers & indicates various methods of managing an enterprise.

Management is a course of study which is now formally being taught in the institutes and universities. After completing a prescribed course or obtaining a degree or diploma in management, a person can get employment as a manager.

Any branch of knowledge that fulfils following two requirements is known as discipline:

- There must be scholars & thinkers who communicate relevant knowledge through research and publications.
- The knowledge should be formally imparted by education and training programs.

Since management satisfies both these problems, it qualifies to be a discipline. Though it is a comparatively new discipline , it is growing at a faster pace.

Management as a group refers to all those persons who perform the task of managing an enterprise. When we say that the management

of ABC & Co. is good, we are referring to a group of people who are managing.

Thus, as a group, technically speaking, management will include all managers from the chief executive to the first-line managers (lower-level managers). But in common practice, management includes only top management, i.e., Chief Executive, Chairman, General Manager, Board of Directors, etc.

In other words, those who are concerned with making important decisions enjoy the authority to use resources to accomplish organizational objectives & also the responsibility for their efficient utilization.

Management as a group may be looked upon in 2 different ways:

- All managers taken together.
- Only the top management

The interpretation depends upon the context in which these terms are used. Broadly speaking, there are 3 types of managers :

- **Patrimonial/Family Manager :** Those who have become managers by virtue of their being owners or relatives of the owners of the company.
- **Professional Managers :** Those who have been appointed on account of their specialized knowledge and degree.
- **Political Managers/Civil Servants :** Those who manage public sector undertakings.

Managers have become a part of the elite group of society as they enjoy a higher standard of living in the society.

As Science : Science is a systematic body of knowledge pertaining to a specific field of study that contains general facts which explains a phenomenon. It establishes a cause- and -effect relationship between two or more variables and underlines the principles

governing their relationship. These principles are developed through the scientific method of observation and verification through testing.

Science is characterized by the following main features:

- **Universally accepted principles :** Scientific principles represent basic truths about a particular field of enquiry. These principles may be applied in all situations, at all times & at all places. E.g., the law of gravitation can be applied in all countries irrespective of the time. Management also contains some fundamental principles which can be applied universally, like the Principle of Unity of Command, i.e., one man, one boss. This principle is applicable to all types of organization — business or non-business.
- **Experimentation & Observation :** Scientific principles are derived through scientific investigation & research, i.e., they are based on logic. E.g., the principle that the Earth goes round the sun has been scientifically proved. Management principles are also based on scientific enquiry & observation, and not only on the opinion of Henry Fayol. They have been developed through experiments & practical experiences of a large numbers of managers. E.g., it is observed that fair remuneration to personnel helps in creating a satisfied workforce.
- **Cause & Effect Relationship :** Principles of science lay down the cause and effect relationship between various variables. E.g., when metals are heated, they expand. The cause is heating & result is expansion. The same is true for management; it also establishes a cause and effect relationship. E.g., lack of parity (balance) between authority & responsibility will lead to ineffectiveness. If you know the cause, i.e., lack of balance, the effect can be ascertained easily i.e. in effectiveness. Similarly, if workers are given bonuses, and fair wages, they will work hard, but when not

treated in a fair and just manner, it reduces the productivity of the organization.

- **Test of Validity & Predictability :** Validity of scientific principles can be tested at any time or any number of times, i.e., they stand the test of time. Each time, these tests will give the same result. Moreover, future events can be predicted with reasonable accuracy by using scientific principles. E.g., H_2 & O_2 will always give H_2O.
- Principles of management can also be tested for validity. E.g., the **principle of unity of command** can be tested by comparing two persons — one having a single boss and one having 2 bosses. The performance of the 1st person will be better than 2nd.

It cannot be denied that management has a systematic body of knowledge but it is not as exact as that of other physical sciences like biology, physics, and chemistry etc. The main reason for the inexactness of the science of management is that it deals with human beings and it is very difficult to predict their behavior accurately.

Since it is a social process, it falls in the area of social sciences. It is a flexible science & that is why its theories and principles may produce different results at different times, and therefore it is a behavior science. Ernest Dale has called it a *Soft Science*.

Art implies application of knowledge & skill to trying about desired results. An art may be defined as personalized application of general theoretical principles for achieving the best possible results. Art has the following characteristics –

- **Practical Knowledge :** Every art requires practical knowledge; therefore learning of theory is not sufficient. It is very important to know practical application of theoretical principles. E.g. to become a good painter, the person may not only be knowing different colors and brushes but different designs, dimensions, situations etc. to use them

appropriately. A manager can never be successful just by obtaining degree or diploma in management; he must also know how to apply various principles in real situations by functioning in capacity of manager.

- **Personal Skill :** Although the theoretical base may be the same for every artist, but each one has their own style and approach towards their job. That is why the level of success and quality of performance differ from one person to another. E.g., there are several qualified painters, but M.F. Hussain is recognized for his style. Similarly, management as an art is also personalized. Every manager has their own way of managing things based on their knowledge, experience and personality, that is why some managers are known as good managers (like Aditya Birla, Rahul Bajaj) whereas others are referred as bad.
- **Creativity :** Every artist has an element of creativity in line. That is why they aim at producing something that has never existed before which requires a combination of intelligence & imagination. Management is also creative in nature ,like any other art. It combines human and non-human resources in a useful way so as to achieve desired results. It tries to produce sweet music by combining chords in an efficient manner.
- **Perfection through practice :** Practice makes a man perfect. Every artist becomes more and more proficient through constant practice. Similarly, managers learn through the art of trial and error initially, but application of management principles over the years makes them perfect in the job of managing.
- **Goal-Oriented :** Every art is result -oriented as it seeks to achieve concrete results. In the same manner, management is also directed towards the accomplishment of pre-determined goals. Managers use various resources like men,

money, material, machinery & methods to promote the growth of an organization.

Thus, we can say that management is an art, therefore it requires the application of certain principles, and it is an art of the highest order because it deals with molding the attitude and behavior of people at work towards desired goals.

Management is both an art and a science. The above-mentioned points clearly reveal that management combines features of both science as well as art. It is considered a science because it has an organized body of knowledge which contains certain universal truths. It is called an art because managing requires certain skills which are personal possessions of managers.

Science provides the knowledge & art deals with the application of knowledge and skills.

A manager to be successful in their profession must acquire the knowledge of science & the art of applying it. Therefore, management is a judicious blend of science as well as an art because it proves the principles, and the way these principles are applied is a matter of art.

Science teaches to 'know' ,and art teaches to 'do'. E.g., a person cannot become a good singer unless he has knowledge about various ragas & he also applies his personal skill in the art of singing. In the same way, it is not sufficient for a manager to first know the principles ,but he must also apply them in solving various managerial problems. That is why science and art are not mutually exclusive, but they are complementary to each other (like tea and biscuit, bread and butter, etc.).

The old saying, "**Managers are Born has been rejected in favor of Managers are Made."** It has been aptly remarked that management is the oldest of the arts and the youngest of science. To conclude, we can say that science is the root and art is the fruit.

Over a few decades, factors such as the growing size of business units, separation of ownership from management, growing competition, etc. have led to an increased demand for professionally qualified managers. The task of a manager has been quite specialized. As a result of these developments, the management has reached a stage where everything is to be managed professionally.

A profession may be defined as an occupation that requires specialized knowledge and intensive academic preparation to which entry is regulated by a representative body. The essentials of a profession are:

- **Specialized Knowledge :** A profession must have a systematic body of knowledge that can be used for the development of professionals. Every professional must make deliberate efforts to acquire expertise in the principles and techniques. Similarly, a manager must have devotion and involvement to acquire expertise in the science of management.
- **Formal Education & Training :** There are number of institutes and universities to impart education & training for a profession. No one can practice a profession without going through a prescribed course. Many institutes of management have been set up for imparting education and training. For example, a CA cannot audit the accounts unless he has acquired a degree or diploma for the same ,but no minimum qualifications and a course of study has not been prescribed for managers by law. For example, an MBA may be preferred but not necessary.
- **Social Obligations :** Profession is a source of livelihood, but professionals are primarily motivated by the desire to serve society. Their actions are influenced by social norms and values. Similarly, a manager is responsible not only to their owners but also to the society and therefore they are

expected to provide quality goods at reasonable prices to the society.

- **Code of Conduct :** Members of a profession have to abide by a code of conduct which contains certain rules and regulations, norms of honesty, integrity and special ethics. A code of conduct is enforced by a representative association to ensure self-discipline among its members. Any member violating the code of conduct can be punished.

From the above discussion, it is quite clear that management fulfills several essentials of a profession, even then it is not a full-fledged profession because: -

- It does not restrict the entry in managerial jobs for the sake of one standard or another.
- No minimum qualifications have been prescribed for managers.
- No management association has the authority to grant a certificate of practice to various managers.
- All managers are supposed to abide by the code formulated by the organization.
- Competent education and training facilities do not exist.
- Managers are responsible for many groups, such as shareholders, employees and society.
- Managers are known by their performance and not by their mere degrees.
- The ultimate goal of business is to maximize profit and not social welfare.

As for leaders' failure, there are numerous reasons that we can think of. For many, it may be in the area of ethical behavior, or failure to delegate properly, and failure to listen to feedback from others, but most probably, trust is one of the main reasons.

Trust is a critical element in the workplace. People have to trust each other on both big and small issues. Seemingly harmless requests or actions that undermine trust can have big consequences.

Why does it matter if employees trust their managers?

When people do not trust their leaders, they are much more likely to leave their positions if the option is available to them. If you are in a leadership position and have a high rate of turnover among employees, one of the issues at play may be a lack of trust.

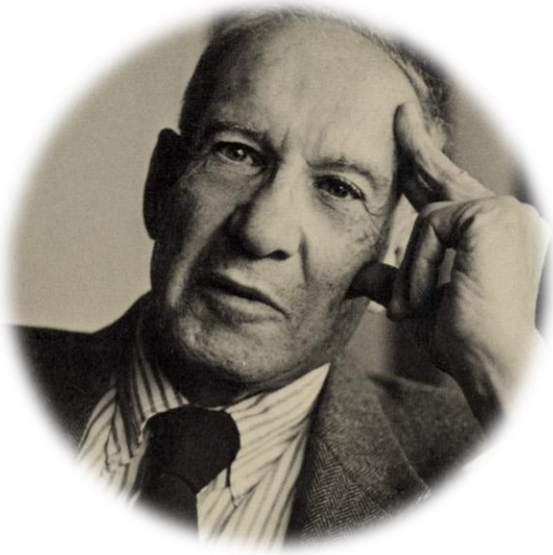
Managers or leaders are always making transgressions that can undermine trust, such as; lying, lacking clean communication, disrespecting others' time, withholding information, creating uncertainty about the future, stealing, demanding face time, enforcing rules unethically, creating unattainable goals,etc.

That is why we need to talk with our ancestors to understand more about management and leadership.

Let us begin the journey!

***

Peter F. Drucker



I'm very excited and contented to be here tonight with the late father of modern management, one of the most widely-known and influential thinkers on management, whose work continues to be used by managers worldwide in such interactive conversations as you would be talking to the real Professor Dr. Peter F. Drucker, but before we start, let me officially introduce my guest.

Who is Peter F. Drucker?

Drucker was a prolific author, and among the first after Taylor and Fayol to depict management as a distinct function and being a manager as a distinct responsibility. His writing showed real understanding of and sympathy for the difficulties and demands faced by managers.

Throughout his long career, he has had interests as diverse as journalism, art appreciation, mountaineering, reading and, of course, management teaching, writing and consultancy.

With 39 books published over seven decades (and translated into at least 30 languages) and many books written about him since his death, Drucker was, by common consent, the founding father of modern management studies[1].

*****

Amr : Let me first state that this is a casual meeting; thus, we will address you without any official title.

So, Peter, tonight we will be discussing and talking about various and general issues on how we should manage, be it the human capital, knowledge workers, and others.

But, at the beginning, let me take you back to 1954 when you introduced the concept of Management by Objectives (MBOs), as a performance management approach in which a balance is sought between the objectives of employees and the objectives of an organization.

However, despite its popularity William Edwards Deming's, critics complaint about being linked to the loose application of MBO principles by organizations and consultants. Would you like to enlighten us?

Peter : Amr, Management by Objectives is the process of defining specific objectives within an organization that management can convey to organization members, then deciding on how to achieve each objective in sequence.

[1] https://www.bl.uk/people/peter-drucker

MBOs Strategy has three basic parts :

1. **Objectives**: Employees and their managers mutually set and agree on the objectives. These individuals strive to reach those goals during a normal operating period.
2. **Performance reviews** : Managers regularly conduct reviews to determine how employees are meeting their goals
3. **Rewards** : Employees receive rewards based on how close they have reached their goals

A manager should act as the conductor of an orchestra who is also the composer of the work, making the best of the resources available, especially the people, avoiding or neutralizing the weaknesses they have, and living and acting in two dimensions of time (present and future), among many others.

Amr : Peter, let me interrupt you and say how this can be accomplished?

Peter : Thanks, Amr, a manager, in the first place, sets objectives. He determines what the goals in each area of objectives should be. He decides what has to be done to reach these objectives. He makes the objectives effective by communicating them to the people whose performance is needed to achieve them.

Second, a manager organizes. He analyses the activities, decisions and relations needed. He classifies the work. He divides it into manageable activities. He further divides the activities into manageable jobs. He groups these units and jobs into an organizational structure. He selects people for the management of these units and for the jobs to be done.

Next, a manager motivates and communicates. He makes a team out of the people who are responsible for various jobs, and does that through the practices with which he manages.

Also, he does it in his own relation to the men he manages. He does it through incentives and rewards for successful work. Moreover, he

does it through his promotion policy, and through constant communication, both from the manager to his subordinate, and from the subordinate to the manager.

The fourth basic element in the work of the manager is the job of measurement. The manager establishes measuring yardsticks — and there are few factors as important to the performance of the organization and of every man in it.

He sees to it that each man in the organization has measurements available to him which are focused on the performance of the whole organization and that, at the same time focus on the work of the individual and help him do it. He analyses performance, appraises it and interprets it.

And again, as in every other area of his work, he communicates both the meaning of the measurements and their findings to his subordinates as well as to his superiors.

Finally, a manager develops people. Through the way he manages, he makes it easy or difficult for them to develop themselves. He directs people or misdirects them. He brings out what is in them or he stifles them. He strengthens their integrity or he corrupts them. He trains them to stand upright and strong or he deforms them. The MBO's process consists of 5 steps :

1. **Review organizational objectives :** The manager gains a clear understanding of the organization's overall objectives
2. **Set employee objectives :** Managers and employees agree on the objectives that the employees should reach during the normal operating period.
3. **Monitor progress :** Managers and employees regularly check whether the employees are reaching their objectives.
4. **Evaluate performance :** Managers judge employees' goal achievements at the end of the normal operating period.

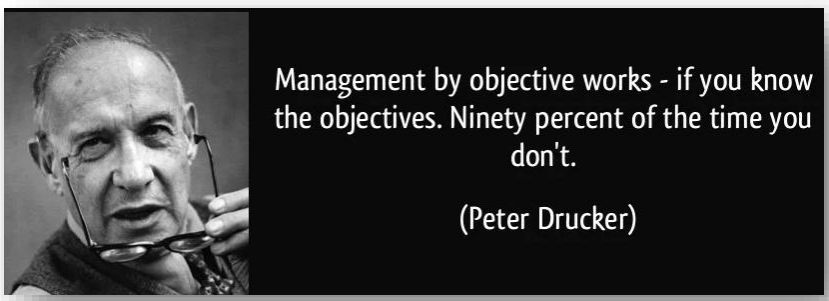
5. **Give rewards :** The employees receive rewards based on the extent to which they reached their objectives.

Amr : Peter, I know some people argue that MBO can be too time-consuming, and that it focuses too heavily on results and, at times, ignores the necessary process. In other words, it may sometimes fail to show the staff exactly how to improve performance in order to reach the agreed goals. Would you comment?

Peter : Well, Amr, the top management should be committed to the MBOs process to succeed, and the objectives should be appropriate for the organization.

- Managers and subordinates together must develop and agree on each individual's goals.
- Employee performance should be conscientiously evaluated against established objectives.
- Management must follow through on employee performance evaluations by rewarding employees accordingly.

For management by objectives to work well, the management must carefully select the right objectives. In addition, managers and employees should not misreport their performance levels as this would distort the system and make it unreliable.



The message behind Management by Objectives is the jointly determining and achieving of objectives and being rewarded for these achievements. It is important to make fair and correct assessments of the achievements against the setting of measurable goals. Clear performance indicators are essential for a good management by objectives approach.

Amr : Thanks, Peter, for your elaboration.

*****

Amr : Again, Peter, as one of your readers and followers, one of your greatest sayings is, **"I'm more interested in people than I am in how businesses work."**

What is that supposed to mean?

Peter : You know Amr, organizations are made by people, for the people, and people's interaction is a very important thing that we usually lose. This posed a great problem in relation to three of eight important practices on what makes executives effective.

Management is about humans. Its purpose is to make people more capable of working together. The best managers find ways to maximize their teams' strengths and minimize their teams' weaknesses.

The loss of interaction hinders communication, asking of what needs to be done, and lastly it hinders running productive meetings, often resulting in the current shambles of skewed priorities and false information.

Effective managers henceforth need to work like our bodies . They are to focus on not losing important information — through constant communication (whether physical or digital), with people inside and outside of their institution.

They can then properly deliberate tasks given their different resources and fundamental limits, based on the information they initially garnered.

Amr : Peter, let us move forward and talk about people and how we should manage and lead them. What are your insights?

Peter : Listen Amr, management deals with people, their values, their growth and development—and this makes it a human behaviour.

At its heart, leading involves dealing with people as human beings. Each person has strengths and weaknesses, specialized knowledge, and a range of communication skills. Leading requires constant empathy and recognition that the diversity of human experience strengthens the organization or team. Also, it requires embracing humility and recognizing that everyone is not always at their best.

Managers draw on all the knowledge and insights of the humanities and the social sciences—on psychology and philosophy, on economics and history, on the physical sciences and ethics.

We manage people, not things. Managers should understand their employees, understand how they think and act. They must also know what makes them tick—what drives them, what motivates them, and what their aspirations are.

Being a manager, you have to acquaint yourself with different approaches to management based on different sets of values and individualize your management approach. Use this understanding to create a productive work environment—that's your foremost responsibility as a manager.

To manage and lead, you have to master, (1) setting objectives, (2) organizing the group, (3) motivating and communicating, (4) measuring performance, and, (5) developing people.

For each of the five, ask yourself two questions: am I truly effective (doing the right thing) or am I merely efficient (doing things right)?

To set objectives, do a feedback analysis on a regular basis. Whenever you take a key decision or action, write down what you expect to happen. Review results at regular intervals and compare them with expectations. Use this feedback as a guide and a goad to reinforce strengths and eliminate weaknesses.

After this organize yourself. Ask three absolutely basic and marvelous time management questions.

- What am I doing that does not need to be done at all?
- What am I doing that can be done by somebody else?
- What am I doing that only I can do?

Obviously, you scrap the first, delegate the second, and concentrate only on tasks in the last question. You'll free up huge quantities of time, but watch out, the unnecessary time-wasters keep on creeping back – shoot them on sight.

Motivating hinges on people identifying themselves with the organization and their own group, and with its products and/or services, while accepting individual and group responsibility for the quality and performance of their work. The key tools are the three

Ps : Pay, Placement and Promotion. That means how you reward people, put the round and square pegs in the appropriate holes, and raise people to realize more of their potential.

Don't measure performance by financial numbers alone. Look for indicators like market share, quality ratings by customers, successful innovations, competitive rankings, customer satisfaction,

employment morale, cost of waste, use of capital, and productivity.

It's a measure of the complexity of the management task that you need to get all these indicators moving upwards at the same time.

Finally, developing yourself and others requires constantly taking action to improve – and there will ALWAYS be room for improvement. So take the six -step action plan :

1. Identify your strengths
2. Improve your strengths
3. Increase your knowledge
4. Eliminate bad habits
5. Practice good manners
6. Avoid weak areas

It's no use just concentrating on yourself; being a good deed in a naughty world won't get you far.

Everybody should have their own individual action plans to guide and improve their performance, making the best use of time by concentrating on strengths and wasting as little as possible on areas of low performance.

Amr : Sounds great Peter.

Peter, we have taken much of your time, but finally let us talk about knowledge workers, the term that you coined in 1959. You know that today's knowledge-based workforce is becoming the largest single group… and has already become the major creator of corporate wealth and competitive advantage. Increasingly, the success, indeed the survival of every business will depend on the performance of its knowledge workforce. What does this mean to you in short?

Peter : Right Amr, I was referring to a growing set of work roles requiring education, qualifications, and the ability to acquire and to apply theoretical and analytical knowledge.

Workforce training, constant retraining and continuous learning activities must climb to the top of the agenda of the individual firm and the nation as well. More than ever before, internal training must prepare its workforce for a rapidly arriving and disruptive future.

People are the only true resource at any organization. To invest in this resource, continuous training and development should be built into all levels of the institution.

Few executives realize that there are two divergent paths for improving access to the information that lies at the core of knowledge work.

The most common approach, giving knowledge workers free access to a wide variety of tools and information resources, presumes that these employees will determine their own work processes and needs.

The other, the structured provision of information and knowledge, involves delivering them to employees within a well-defined context of tasks and deliverables. Computers send batches of work to employees and provide the information needed to do it.

Both the free-access and structured-provisioning approaches are in wide use, but they make radically different assumptions about how knowledge work should be performed and how its productivity can be improved.

Executives who aren't conscious of the trade-offs they are making between them and thus don't look for opportunities to harness the power of structure probably won't get the most from knowledge workers.

Thus, there are three ways of knowing: Knowing-why reflects our individual responses to the question: Why do we work? Knowing-how reflects our individual responses to the question: How do we work? and Knowing-whom involves our responses to the question: With whom do we work?

Amr, we live in a world where knowledge-based work is expanding rapidly .I think this is enough for tonight.

One last thing to remember Amr, all management books, including those I have written, focus on managing other people. But you cannot manage other people unless you manage yourself first.

Amr : And how is that, Peter?

Peter : The most crucial and vital resource you have as a manager is yourself, and your organization is not going to do better than you do yourself. So, the first thing to say about the development of your company is : **development.**

That is a very general term. Development is, foremost, dependent on how much you get out of the one resource that is truly under your own command and control, namely: yourself. When I look at all the organizations, I have worked with over a long life, there is a difference between the successful ones and the great majority, who are, at best, mediocre.

The difference is that the people who are running the successful ones manage themselves. They know their strengths - and it is amazing how few people really know what they are good at. You do not know it unless you work at finding out what you are good at. You have to have an eye on yourself.

Most of the people I know who have done an outstanding job, and the number is not very large, have systematically organized finding out what they are really good at.

Whenever you do something of significance, whenever you are making an important decision, and especially whenever you are making a decision about people, that is your most important decision. Usually you write down what you expect the results to be and nine months or a year later, you look at it. This way you will see very soon what you are good at, where you need to learn, where you need to improve and where you are simply not gifted.

The second thing is to pay a great deal of attention to how and where you place other people. Again, place people where their strengths

can produce results. What differentiates a successful organization from most others is the way they place their people. It is important to realize that the people at the top set the example.

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Amr : One more thing Peter. What are the things that managers will have to keep an eye on?

Peter : Amr, the first thing is to have an eye on yourself and the next on what goes on outside. Make sure that you sit down with your own people once a week, maybe once a month, quietly for a long time, and ask them: what do we in this company do that helps you? What do we in this company do that hampers you? What do I, as your boss, do that helps you? What do I as your boss do that hampers you?

There are two requirements to being a boss. One is to set the right example, and the other is to help and enable his/her people to perform.

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Amr : Peter, before we end for tonight, how do you see the role of women managers in professional management?

Peter : You are asking the wrong person, Amr, because, you know, as I grew up ,my mother was a professional woman, the second woman pediatrician in Austria (the first one was her cousin).

My wife is also a professional woman . I ran a women's college, and I was the first person in the United States to admit women to a graduate business school, so I am obviously not impartial, and I have worked very well with women. I have never had any problems.

Women are making extraordinary careers in finance and accounting, and they are incredibly gifted in it. They are succeeding where men are phasing out since women began to take over.

But I think you can expect, from now on, women to have an increasingly more professional focus: the kind of women that may sit at home terribly bored or the ones who are becoming part of the major accounting firms, part of the major law firms, taking over in medicine where women were almost unknown except as nurses 45 years ago.

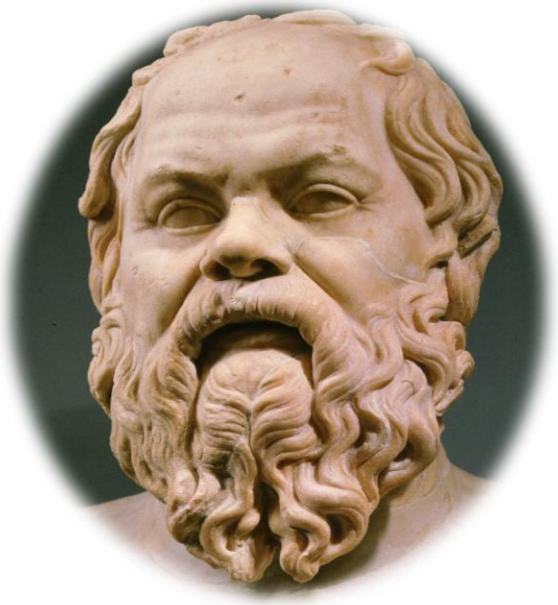
So, I think that women are increasingly taking over professional and managerial jobs, and increasingly, that is no longer a problem.

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Amr : Thanks, Peter, for such a wealthy event and for being with us tonight.

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Socrates



Socrates (born c. 470 BCE, Athens [Greece]—died 399 BCE, Athens) ancient Greek philosopher whose way of life, character, and thought exerted a profound influence on Classical antiquity and Western philosophy.

Who is Socrates?

Socrates lived during the Golden Age of Athens, a period of great cultural and intellectual achievement. Socrates is best known for his philosophical method of questioning, known as the Socratic method, which involved engaging in dialogue with others to uncover the truth through critical thinking and self-examination.

He did not leave behind any writings of his own, so much of what is known about him comes from the works of his students, particularly Plato. Socrates believed in the importance of pursuing knowledge

and self-improvement, and he often challenged the conventional wisdom of his time. He was known for his sharp wit and relentless questioning of the beliefs and values of society.

Socrates' teachings and methods made him unpopular with the political and religious authorities of Athens, and he was ultimately sentenced to death by drinking poison hemlock in 399 BC. His trial and death are depicted in Plato's dialogue, Apology.

Despite his controversial death, Socrates' teachings had a profound influence on Western philosophy and continue to be studied and revered to this day. His emphasis on the pursuit of knowledge, self-examination, and critical thinking has left a lasting legacy in the history of philosophy.

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Amr : Good evening, Socrates. It is an honor and a privilege to get to meet with you, to learn some of your wisdom, and I know how busy you are.

Socrates : With pleasure, Amr, seeking wisdom is a noble pursuit. I am honored to share what I have learned. Please, ask your questions, and I shall do my best to provide insightful answers.

Amr : Let's start by talking about your philosophical views. You are often quoted as saying, **"The only true wisdom is in knowing you know nothing."** Can you elaborate on this idea?

Socrates : Certainly. I believe that true wisdom comes from acknowledging our own limitations and understanding that we may not have all the answers. By recognizing our own ignorance, we open ourselves up to learning and growing. It is important to constantly question and examine our beliefs and ideas in order to deepen our understanding of the world.

Amr : That's a very humble approach to knowledge. How did you come to develop this philosophy?

Socrates : My philosophy is rooted in the belief that the unexamined life is not worth living. I spent much of my life engaging in dialogue and debate with others, questioning everything and challenging conventional wisdom. Through these conversations, I came to realize the importance of self-awareness and humility in the pursuit of truth.

Amr : Your method of questioning and challenging others' beliefs earned you many followers, as well as some enemies. How did you handle criticism and opposition in your time?

Socrates : I always welcomed criticism and opposition, as I believed that it was through these challenges that I could grow and learn. I encouraged my followers to think for themselves and to question everything, just as I did. Of course, not everyone appreciated my approach, and I faced opposition from those who felt threatened by my teachings. Ultimately, though, I remained true to my beliefs and continued to engage in philosophical inquiry until the end of my life.

Amr : Your commitment to philosophical inquiry is certainly admirable. Looking back on your life and teachings, what do you hope people will remember you for?

Socrates : I hope to be remembered as a philosopher who inspired others to question, to think critically, and to seek truth. I hope that my legacy will live on in the minds of those who continue to engage in philosophical inquiry and strive for self-improvement. Ultimately, I believe that the pursuit of wisdom and self-awareness is the highest calling of humanity, and I hope that my teachings will continue to inspire others to lead examined lives.

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Amr : Let us move to discuss your approach to *Critical Thinking*. Can you define it for us? And give us some details?

Socrates : Sure, Amr, my famous method is known as the Socratic Method. It is a form of inquiry and discussion aimed at stimulating critical thinking and the pursuit of truth. Rather than providing direct answers, I engage in a dialogue with individuals, posing thought-provoking questions to encourage them to examine their own beliefs and arrive at their own conclusions.

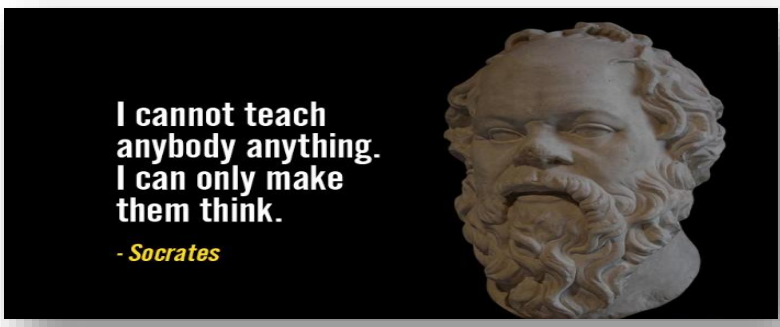
Through this method, I aim to lead others to self-discovery and a deeper understanding of themselves and the world around them.

I shall outline the basic steps of the Method:

- **Questioning Assumptions:**
    - The Socratic Method begins by questioning the assumptions or beliefs held by an individual or a group. By challenging these assumptions, we encourage critical thinking and a deeper examination of one's own beliefs.
- **Clarification:**
    - It is important to seek clarity and a clear understanding of the ideas being discussed. This involves asking probing questions to define key terms, concepts, and principles.
- **Eliciting Examples:**
    - By asking for specific examples or instances, we can further explore and illustrate the ideas under discussion. This helps to solidify understanding and highlight any inconsistencies or contradictions.
- **Logical Reasoning:**
    - Employing logical reasoning is essential in the Socratic Method. We engage in deductive and inductive reasoning to examine the soundness of arguments and evaluate their validity.

- **Challenging Contradictions:**
    - Through skillful questioning, we aim to identify any contradictions or inconsistencies within the arguments presented. This process encourages individuals to reflect on their own beliefs and consider alternative perspectives.
- **Arriving at Truth:**
    - The ultimate goal of the Socratic Method is to arrive at a deeper understanding of truth and wisdom. While direct answers may not always be provided, the process of questioning and self-reflection helps individuals to uncover the truth through their own reasoning and introspection.

Remember, these steps are not rigid and may vary depending on the context and subject matter under discussion. The method is a dynamic and fluid approach to learning and inquiry.



Amr : Please give us an example.

Socrates : Certainly, let me provide you with an example of the Socratic Method in action:

Let's imagine a discussion about the concept of justice. I may approach the conversation by questioning the assumptions and

beliefs about justice held by the participants. For example, I could ask:

- What do you believe is the essence of justice?

Once they offer their initial definitions or ideas, I would seek clarification by asking further questions:

- How do you determine what is just and unjust?
- Can you provide specific examples of situations that you believe exemplify justice?

As the discussion progresses, I might challenge their assumptions and contradictions:

- If justice is about treating others fairly, how do we determine what is fair in different situations?
- Do you believe justice is a fixed concept, or does it change depending on the circumstances?

Through this process, individuals are encouraged to critically examine their own beliefs and consider alternative perspectives. They may refine their definitions of justice and reach a deeper understanding through logical reasoning and introspection.

Remember, the method is not about finding a singular correct answer, but rather about engaging in thoughtful dialogue to stimulate intellectual growth and self-discovery.

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Amr : My next question is, can we apply it in modern management?

Socrates : Indeed, the Socratic Method can be applied to modern management practices. By employing this method, managers can foster critical thinking, encourage open dialogues, and promote effective decision-making within their teams.

- **Encouraging Critical Thinking :**
    - Managers can ask thought-provoking questions that challenge assumptions and stimulate critical thinking among their team members. This helps to broaden perspectives, foster creativity, and promote innovative problem-solving.
- **Facilitating Open Dialogue :**
    - The method can be used to create a safe and inclusive environment for open dialogues, where team members feel comfortable expressing their ideas, concerns, and suggestions. Through skillful questioning, managers can guide discussions, encourage active participation, and ensure that all viewpoints are considered.
- **Promoting Self-Reflection :**
    - By asking reflective questions, managers can help team members reflect on their own strengths, weaknesses, and areas for growth. This self-awareness fosters personal development and contributes to a culture of continuous improvement.
- **Developing Leadership Skills :**
    - It can be employed in leadership development programs to help aspiring leaders enhance their critical thinking, communication, and decision-making skills. By engaging in dialogues and self-reflection, future leaders can develop a deeper understanding of their own values, strengths, and areas of development.
- **Resolving Conflicts :**
    - When conflicts arise within a team, the Socratic Method can be used to facilitate constructive discussions and help team members understand different perspectives. By asking questions that encourage empathy and understanding, managers can

guide the team towards consensus and effective resolution of conflicts.

By incorporating the Socratic Method into modern management practices, managers can foster an environment of intellectual growth, critical thinking, and collaborative problem-solving, ultimately leading to enhanced team performance and organizational success.

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Amr : Thank you for sharing your insights with us, Socrates. Your wisdom and humility continue to inspire us to this day.

Socrates : The pleasure was mine. Thank you for the engaging conversation.

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Marcus Aurelius



Marcus Aurelius (121-180 CE) was a Roman emperor who ruled from 161 to 180 CE. He is best known for his philosophical writings and is considered one of the most important Stoic philosophers.

Who is Marcus Aurelius?

Marcus Aurelius was born in Rome on April 26, 121 CE. He came from a prominent family and received an excellent education, studying philosophy, rhetoric, and law. He became interested in Stoic philosophy at a young age and was influenced by the teachings of Epictetus, Seneca the Younger, and other Stoic philosophers.

In 161 CE, Marcus Aurelius became the emperor of Rome, jointly ruling with Lucius Verus until Verus' death in 169 CE. As an emperor, Marcus Aurelius faced numerous challenges, including military campaigns against Germanic tribes and the Parthian

Empire. Despite these difficulties, he is often regarded as one of the philosopher-kings due to his commitment to philosophy and virtue.

Marcus Aurelius is known for his work called *Meditations*, a collection of personal writings and reflections. In this philosophical treatise, he contemplated various aspects of life, ethics, and the nature of the universe. *Meditations* provides insights into Stoic philosophy, emphasizing the importance of virtue, self-discipline, and acceptance of one's fate.

During his reign, Marcus Aurelius implemented several reforms aimed at improving the welfare of his subjects. He emphasized the importance of justice, tolerance, and the rule of law. He also supported the arts and sciences and sponsored the education of orphaned children.

Marcus Aurelius died on March 17, 180 CE, while on a military campaign in present-day Austria. After his death, he was succeeded by his son, Commodus, who proved to be a much less capable ruler.

Marcus Aurelius is remembered as one of the great philosopher-emperors of Rome. His writings have had a lasting impact on Western philosophy and continue to be studied and appreciated even today.

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Amr : At the outset, I am very much honored to be with you on this third night, Marcus Aurelius. You have placed great emphasis on moral character and virtue in your philosophy, and believed that the development of one's character is crucial for leading a good and fulfilling life. Can you elaborate this for us?

Marcus : Indeed, I firmly believed that the development of one's character and the pursuit of moral virtue were of utmost importance in leading a good and fulfilling life. In my philosophy, known as **Stoicism**, I emphasized the cultivation of wisdom, justice, courage, and temperance as the key virtues to aspire towards.

Wisdom, or the pursuit of knowledge and understanding, allows us to see the world clearly and make rational judgments. Justice encourages us to treat others fairly and equitably, recognizing the inherent worth and dignity of every individual. Courage enables us to face challenges and adversity with resilience and fortitude. Temperance guides us in maintaining self-control and moderation in our desires and impulses.

By cultivating these virtues, one can align their thoughts, actions, and intentions with reason and livein harmony with nature. I believed that by focusing on our own moral character and striving to live virtuously, we could find inner tranquility and fulfill our duties as human beings.

It is important to note that I saw virtue as a matter of personal growth and self-improvement, rather than a means of judgment or comparison to others. Each individual has the capacity to develop their own character and cultivate virtue, regardless of their external circumstances or societal status.

Marcus : Amr, let us see some aspects of what I meant of moral character:

1. Integrity is the importance of acting with integrity and being true to oneself, all individuals should strive to align their actions with their principles and values.
2. Justice is a central virtue. I greatly believed in treating others fairly and equitably in all aspects of life, both in personal interactions and in the administration of public affairs.
3. Wisdom is seeking knowledge and understanding which are essential for personal growth and making sound decisions. I encouraged continuous learning and reflection as means of cultivating wisdom.
4. Courage is another virtue that I admire. The importance of facing challenges and adversities with bravery and resilience,

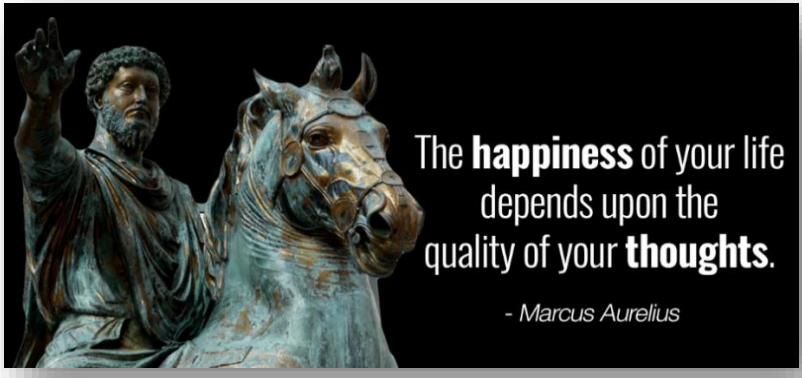
both in the pursuit of personal growth and in the service of others.

5. Temperance is the importance of self-control and moderation.
6. Compassion is the importance of empathy towards others. I greatly believed in the interconnectedness of humanity and encouraged kindness and understanding.

Amr : Great!But how can we apply it into modern management practices?

Marcus : Ah, the application of Stoic philosophy to modern management practices is indeed a fascinating topic. While the context of management has changed since my time, the principles of virtue and ethical conduct remain relevant.

First and foremost, a Stoic approach to management would emphasize the importance of maintaining one's own moral character as a leader. This means embodying the virtues of wisdom, justice, courage, and temperance in decision-making and behavior. Leaders should strive to act with integrity, fairness, and a long-term perspective, considering the well-being of all stakeholders.



Furthermore, Stoicism encourages leaders to focus on what they can control and accept what they cannot. In a managerial role, this

entails focusing on one's own actions and decisions, rather than becoming overly concerned with external circumstances or the actions of others.

By cultivating a mindset of resilience and adaptability, leaders can navigate challenges and setbacks with composure.

Effective communication is also paramount in modern management, and Stoic principles can guide leaders in this aspect. Stoicism calls for clarity, honesty, and empathy in communication, ensuring that messages are delivered with integrity and respect for others.

Leaders should strive to foster an environment of open dialogue and collaboration, while maintaining a focus on ethical conduct and the greater good.

Lastly, a Stoic approach to modern management would encourage leaders to cultivate a sense of equanimity and detachment from outcomes. This does not imply indifference or lack of ambition, but rather recognizing that external events are beyond our control.

Leaders should focus on making reasoned decisions and taking action, while embracing whatever outcomes may arise with equanimity and adaptability.

By integrating Stoic principles into modern management practices, leaders can foster an environment of ethical leadership, personal growth, and resilience, ultimately leading to greater success and fulfillment for themselves and their organizations.

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Amr : Being an emperor, what were your major strengths?

Marcus : As an emperor, I sought to leverage my strengths and virtues for the benefit of the Roman Empire. Here are some of the strengths that I aimed to bring to my role:

- **Leadership and Governance:**
  - I believed in the importance of effective leadership and sought to fulfill my duties as Emperor with diligence and competence. I focused on maintaining stability, enforcing laws, and promoting the welfare of the people within the empire.
  - My adherence to Stoic principles helped me approach governance with reason and a sense of justice.
- **Diplomacy and Negotiation:**
  - I recognized the significance of maintaining peaceful relations with other nations. I engaged in diplomatic efforts, seeking to resolve conflicts through negotiation rather than resorting to war whenever possible. I believed that a peaceful and stable empire was crucial for the well-being of its citizens.
- **Military Strategy and Defense:**
  - I understood the need for a strong and capable military to protect the empire from external threats. I worked to ensure that the Roman army was well-trained, well-equipped, and well-organized. Additionally, I developed strategies to defend the borders and maintain the security of the empire.
- **Administrative Efficiency:**
  - I placed importance on effective administration and governance. I aimed to streamline bureaucratic processes, reduce inefficiencies, and promote responsible fiscal management. By prioritizing the welfare of the empire and its citizens, I sought to ensure the efficient functioning of the state.
- **Moral Exemplar:**
  - As an emperor, I believed that leading by example was crucial. I endeavored to embody the virtues of Stoicism and serve as a moral exemplar for others to follow. By maintaining my own character and conducting myself with

integrity, I aimed to inspire others towards virtuous behavior.

These strengths, in combination with my philosophical outlook and commitment to virtue, allowed me to govern the empire with a sense of duty, wisdom, and a focus on the well-being of the people.

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Amr : My last question for tonight is, what is your leadership style?

Marcus : My leadership style as an emperor was rooted in a combination of Stoic philosophy and the principles of Roman governance. I adopted a collaborative and consultative approach, seeking to involve advisers and experts in decision-making processes. However, it is important to note that as an emperor, my decisions ultimately held the highest authority.

One of the key aspects of my leadership style was a commitment to justice and fairness. I believed in treating all individuals with equal respect and dignity, regardless of their social status or background. I aimed to make decisions that were guided by reason and a sense of what was morally right, rather than being swayed by personal biases or self-interest.

I also valued open communication, encouraging a climate of honest and constructive dialogue. I welcomed differing perspectives and sought to consider multiple viewpoints before making decisions. It was important to me to create an environment where individuals felt comfortable expressing their opinions, fostering a culture of intellectual exchange and growth.

Furthermore, as a Stoic philosopher, I placed great emphasis on self-discipline and self-control. I endeavored to govern my own emotions and impulses, remaining calm and composed even in challenging circumstances. This allowed me to approach decision-making with a clear and rational mind, free from the influence of fleeting emotions.

Lastly, I saw my role as an emperor as one of service and duty. I felt a deep responsibility towards the well-being of the Roman Empire and its people. This sense of duty motivated me to work diligently, striving to make decisions that would benefit the empire as a whole, rather than serving my own interests.

In summary, my leadership style as Emperor was characterized by a commitment to justice, fairness, open communication, self-discipline, and a strong sense of duty. It aimed to harmonize the principles of Stoic philosophy with the practical requirements of governance in the Roman Empire.

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Amr : Your Majesty, Marcus Aurelius, I was very pleased to meet you and talk with you on this enlightening evening. Thank you.

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Abraham H. Maslow



Abraham Harold Maslow, American psychologist and philosopher, best known for his self-actualization theory of psychology, which argued that the primary goal of psychotherapy should be the integration of the self[2]. Maslow was one of the most influential psychologists of the twentieth century.

Who is Abraham H. Maslow?

Abraham Harold Maslow was an American psychologist who is best known for creating Maslow's hierarchy of needs, a theory that describes human motivation and the stages of personal growth. He

[2] https://www.britannica.com/biography/Abraham-H-Maslow

was born on April 1, 1908, in Brooklyn, New York, and died on June 8, 1970, in Menlo Park, California.

Maslow studied psychology at the University of Wisconsin and earned his Ph.D. from the University of Wisconsin-Madison in 1934. He went on to work at several universities, including Columbia University, Brandeis University, and Brooklyn College. Throughout his career, Maslow conducted research on human motivation, personality, and self-actualization.

Maslow's most famous work is his hierarchy of needs, which posits that people are motivated to fulfill their basic needs first before moving on to higher-level needs, such as self-esteem and self-actualization. The hierarchy consists of five levels: physiological, safety, love/belonging, esteem, and self-actualization.

Maslow's theory has had a significant impact on psychology and has been widely studied and used in various fields, including education, business, and personal development. He is considered one of the founders of humanistic psychology, a branch of psychology that focuses on human potential, growth, and self-actualization.

In addition to his work on motivation and humanistic psychology, Maslow also made contributions to the fields of positive psychology, transpersonal psychology, and existential psychology. He wrote several books, including ***Toward a Psychology of Being and Motivation and Personality***.

Abraham Maslow's work continues to be influential in the study of human behavior and motivation, and his hierarchy of needs remains a foundational concept in psychology and other related fields.

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Amr : Good evening, Abraham, and thanks for accepting my invitation of tonight.

Abraham, you have argued that the biggest motivating factor that pushed you to propose Maslow's hierarchy of needs theory was a desire to understand human happiness. Would you further explain it to us, particularly since we are living in trying times now?



Abraham : Glad to be with you on this night, Amr.

As a matter of fact, I have had a tough childhood because I grew up in a multiethnic neighborhood in Brooklyn, New York, and despite shouldering the burden of guiding my six younger siblings, I had a major personal issue that affected me significantly. Such a situation was worsened by the fact that my family was not financially stable, and was not keen on educating me.

On the other hand, I had a strained relationship with my mother because of her selfishness and the inappropriate values she tried to instill in my siblings and me. This forced me to spend much time away from home because of my overbearing mother as well as the tough life I lived at home.

I have tried various activities to keep myself busy, but ended up spending much time in the local library to heighten my interest and

passion for reading and advancing my knowledge, and had enrolled and dropped out of numerous colleges before finally settling for the University of Wisconsin, and graduated as a trained psychologist.

My family life and the nature of my upbringing influenced my research studies and psychological concepts significantly.

Anyhow, my research towards developing the theory examined the behavior of perfect individuals and avoided psychologically ill and irrational people. My theory focuses on exploring the concept of human motivation, and in addition, it identifies and explains the various phases of human motivation depending on the needs of an individual.

Amr : Wow! What a life you have lived. Abraham. So, let us focus on your theory **Hierarchy of Needs**.

Abraham : Alright, Amr, it is as simple as that; if you are hungry and thirsty, you will tend to try to take care of the thirst first. After all, you can do without food for weeks, but you can only do without water for a couple of days! Thirst is a stronger need than hunger.

Likewise, if you are very thirsty, but someone has put a choke hold on you and you can't breathe, which is more important? The need to breathe, of course.

In my theory, I referred to self-actualization as a growth need, and separating it from the lower four levels on the hierarchy, which I called deficiency needs.

So, Amr, if you fail to meet your deficiency needs, you'll experience harmful or unpleasant results. Conditions ranging from illness and starvation to loneliness and self-doubt are the byproducts of unmet deficiency needs.

By contrast, self-actualization needs can make you happier, but you are not harmed when these needs go unfulfilled. Thus, self-

actualization needs become a priority only when the other four foundational needs are met. Is that clear now?

Amr : Crystal clear Abraham.

Abraham : Amr, let me add one more thing for you to think of. Ask people for their philosophy of the future -- what would their ideal life or world be like and get significant information as to what needs they do or do not have covered.

Amr : So many people interpret Self-Actualization differently, personally I may call it Self-Worth, can we have some in-depth explanation, Abraham?

Abraham : I called this level growth motivation (in contrast to deficit motivation), being needs (or B-needs, in contrast to D-needs), and self-actualization.

These are needs that do not involve balance. Once engaged, they continue to be felt. In fact, they are likely to become stronger as we feed them! They involve the continuous desire to fulfill potentials, to be all that you can be. They are a matter of becoming the most complete, the fullest, you -- hence the term, self-actualization.

If you want to be truly self-actualizing, you need to have your lower needs taken care of, at least to a considerable extent. This makes sense: If you are hungry, you are scrambling to get food; If you are unsafe, you have to be continuously on guard; If you are isolated and unloved, you have to satisfy that need; If you have a low sense of self-esteem, you have to be defensive or compensate. When lower needs are unmet, you can't fully devote yourself to fulfilling your potential.

Amr : But, how can we know who is the self-actualized person, Abraham?

Abraham : To answer that, we need to look at the kind of people he called self-actualizers by using a qualitative method called biographical analysis.

Pick out a group of people, some historical figures, some people you know, who you feel clearly meet the standard of self-actualization.

Look at their biographies, writings, the acts and words of those you know personally, and so on. From these sources, he developed a list of qualities that seemed characteristic of these people, as opposed to the great mass of us.

These people were reality-centered, which means they could differentiate what is fake and dishonest from what is real and genuine. They were problem-centered, meaning they treated life's difficulties as problems demanding solutions, not as personal troubles to be railed at or surrendered to.

And they had a different perception of means and ends. They felt that the ends don't necessarily justify the means, that the means could be ends themselves, and that the means — the journey —was often more important than the ends.

The self-actualizers also had a different way of relating to others. First, they enjoyed solitude and were comfortable being alone. And they enjoyed deeper personal relations with a few close friends and family members, rather than more shallow relationships with many people.

They enjoyed autonomy, a relative independence from physical and social needs. And they resisted enculturation, that is, they were not susceptible to social pressure to be well adjusted or to fit in — they were, in fact, nonconformists in the best sense.

They had an unhostile sense of humor — preferring to joke at their own expense, or at the human condition, and never directing their humor at others. They had a quality he called acceptance of self and others, by which he meant that these people would be more likely to

take you as you are than try to change you into what they thought you should be. This same acceptance applied to their attitudes towards themselves: If some quality of theirs wasn't harmful, they let it be, even enjoying it as a personal quirk.

On the other hand, they were often strongly motivated to change negative qualities in themselves that could be changed. Along with this comes spontaneity and simplicity: They preferred being themselves rather than being pretentious or artificial. In fact, for all their nonconformity, he found that they tended to be conventional on the surface, just where less self-actualizing nonconformists tend to be the most dramatic.

Further, they had a sense of humility and respect towards others — something Maslow also called democratic values — meaning that they were open to ethnic and individual variety, even treasuring it. They had a quality human kinship — social interest, compassion, humanity. And this was accompanied by a strong ethics, which was spiritual but seldom conventionally religious in nature.

And these people had a certain freshness of appreciation, an ability to see things, even ordinary things, with wonder. Along with this comes their ability to be creative, inventive, and original. And, finally, these people tended to have more peak experiences than the average person. A peak experience is one that takes you out of yourself, that makes you feel very tiny, or very large, to some extent one with life or nature or God. It gives you a feeling of being a part of the infinite and the eternal.

These experiences tend to leave their mark on a person, change them for the better, and many people actively seek them out. They are also called mystical experiences, and are an important part of many religious and philosophical traditions.

Amr : Abraham, can we summarize the self-actualization in just few words?

Abraham : Self-actualization is the final stage in the linear growth of an individual, and the characteristics possessed by self-actualized individuals are:

- **Acceptance and realism :**
  - Self-actualization reflects the individual's acceptance of who he/she is, what he/she is capable of, and his/her realistic and accurate perception of the world around him or her (including the people within it and how they relate to the individual).
- **Problem-centering :**
  - Self-actualized individuals are not purely focused on internal gain; they appreciate the benefits of solving problems that affect others so as to improve the external world. The desire to assist others is borne out of an internal sense of right and wrong, which is grounded in empathy.
- **Spontaneity :**
  - The self-actualized individual thinks and acts spontaneously, as a result of having an accurate self- and world-view. In spite of this spontaneity, these individuals tend to act and think within the accepted social norms and according to the expectations of others. These individuals are also usually open in their interactions with others, yet unconventional in their interaction styles, speech, and other aspects of behavior.
- **Autonomy and Solitude :**
  - While the self-actualized among us conform to societal norms and are often people-centered in their problem-solving, they often display the need for personal freedom and privacy. These private times are spent testing their potential, both mentally (i.e., thinking about their problems) and physically (i.e., acting out to identify strengths and weaknesses).

- **Continued Freshness of Appreciation :**
  - No matter how simple, straightforward or familiar an experience, the self-actualized individual is capable of seeing things from new perspectives and appreciating the breadth and wonder of things in his/her world. This capacity allows these individuals to develop new problem-solving strategies, and it fosters creativity as a result.
- **Peak Experiences :**
  - These are experiences that display three core characteristics: significance, fulfillment, and spirituality. These intense psychophysiological experiences include joy, wonder, awe, and ecstasy, and in self-actualized people, they are thought to be more common. These peak experiences are thought to produce invigorating feelings such as inspiration, physical and mental vitality, and a renewed sense of perspective.

PHYSIOLOGICAL	Safe work environment, Proper lighting, Clean facilities, Heat. The correct tools to do the best job.
SAFETY	Treat coworkers with respect. Allow them the freedom to take risks and not be harshly criticized or humiliated.
BELONGING	Give everyone the opportunity to be heard. Create a sense of community. Coworkers are part of something bigger than themselves. They have a clear understanding of a value-centered mission.
ESTEEM	Empowerment. Public praise. Employee recognition programs. Understanding that each person's job contributes to the ultimate success of the company. Making everyone feel valued and important.
SELF-ACTUALIZATION	Give employees the opportunity to think big, to be creative, to have a vision for the future, to reinvent, and provide direct input to senior leadership.

Amr : Great, but how to put that into workplace, generally speaking, Abraham?

Abraham : Every business wants their employees to think big, work hard, be inspired, and even be inspirational. So, what do they need to do their best? Let us apply my theory, Amr.

When your people know that you're treating them right, they'll feel motivated to give their best in return. Conversely, if you ignore your team members' needs, they'll likely feel demotivated or disengaged. They may even end up leaving.

Good leaders recognize that, if they're to build productive and highly successful teams, they need to understand and address the needs and well-being of team members. But this wasn't always the way.

But, if you implement it quite well and have the intuitive gaze that can identify an employee's psyche from the way of working and behavioral ethics, this is a theory you can test.

Amr : My last question, Abraham, before we end-up for tonight. How can the hierarchy of needs be applied to enhance the leadership traits of individuals?

Abraham : Amr, each individual is unique ,and the motivation for self-actualization leads people in different directions. It is important to note that self-actualization is a continual process, and have you ever resonated that there seem to be as many different ways to enhance the leadership traits of individuals?

Therefore, we can use the hierarchy of needs in the context of improving employee engagement. This will involve facilitating leadership development by concluding the high-level essentials that comprise employee needs. Evaluating employees' feelings of belonging, motivating and interacting with other team units is imperative to know where they belong on the range.

The most compelling principle is to identify the strengths, weaknesses, and regulations of their team partners to help them become the most valuable properties for the company.

Amr, please understand that managers who are successful in one function are sometimes, but by no means always, successful in another. The same is true of leadership at different organizational levels.

On the other hand, leaders who differ notably in abilities and traits are sometimes equally successful when they succeed each other in a given situation.

The hierarchy of needs proposed that human beings are driven by various needs, which are categorized in an order. These human needs form a significant part of human nature. Leaders are rational and self-actualized beings, more superior than the followers they lead.

Those in leadership can use my model to help them to improve the potential of an individual and an organization. Within the organization, individuals have different needs which must be met for them to be motivated and improve their productivity. The physiological needs within the organization comprise the base salary, air, and heat. These are the deficiency needs which must be met within the organization. Safety needs comprise safe working environments, fringe benefits, and job security.

The belonging needs include the work groups, coworkers, and supervisors. Effective leaders understand individual needs and how to meet these needs. Recognition, approval, and increased responsibilities form the esteem needs with the organizations. The self-actualization needs comprise of the opportunities for career advancement, autonomy at work, personal growth, and creativity.

Understanding the position of each person or group on the pyramid within the organization aids in determining effective motivators for

every team member. For instance, motivating an individual in the middle-class position with a certificate has a greater impact in his or her motivation than rewarding the same to an individual in the lower class-minimum wage— who is struggling to meet the basic needs.

Leaders must also understand that everybody strives to move up from the current position, but forces of nature are constantly pushing them down. People on the top are pushed down by circumstances such as failure of ideas and plans or deaths. Those on the bottom are pushed by an issue which favors their earning such lower prices or better health. The goal of leaders remains to help followers to gain skills and knowledge which allow for transitioning into upper levels within the hierarchy permanently.

Workers whose needs are met become more productive, by concentrating on goals and vision of the organization rather than consistent struggle to make ends meet.

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Amr : Many thanks for this evening and for your insights.

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Alexander The Great



Alexander the Great, a Macedonian King, conquered the eastern Mediterranean, Egypt, the Middle East, and parts of Asia in a remarkably short period of time. His empire ushered in significant cultural changes in the lands he conquered and changed the course of the region's history. He operated on a broad palette but also paid attention to details to a degree rarely seen before or since, and is often considered the most successful world leader in history. He is remembered as one of the most celebrated conquerors of the ancient world, one of history's greatest warriors, and a legend of almost divine status in his own lifetime. He falls into the category of individuals who changed the history of civilization and shaped the present world as we know it. He accomplished greater deeds than any other leader before or after him.

Who is Alexander the Great?

I, Alexander, later known to the world as Alexander the Great, was born in Pella, the ancient capital of Macedonia, on July 356 BC. My father was none other than Philip II, King of Macedon, and my mother was his fourth wife, Olympias, the daughter of the King of Epirus.

As a young boy, I was tutored by the philosopher Aristotle, who instilled in me a fascination for the works of Homer, and I held the Iliad close to my heart throughout my life. The teachings of Aristotle shaped my worldview and instilled in me a deep love for knowledge and exploration. Under his tutelage, I learned the art of war, philosophy, politics, and sciences, all of which greatly influenced my future conquests and governance.

My father, Philip II, was assassinated in 336 BC, and I ascended to the throne of Macedon at the tender age of 20. Faced with internal unrest and external threats, I acted quickly to secure my kingdom. I quashed the rebellions and reestablished Macedonian power within Greece. With Greece secure, I set my sights on a larger stage, the Persian Empire.

In 334 BC, I had led my forces across the Hellespont into Asia Minor. At the Battle of Granicus, I won a decisive victory against the Persian satraps. This marked the beginning of my campaign against the Persian Empire, ruled by King Darius III. Over the next few years, my forces and I vanquished the mighty Persian Empire, including notable victories at Issus and Gaugamela, leading to the fall of the Persian capital, Persepolis, in 330 BC. Having defeated Darius III, I declared myself King of Asia. I pushed further eastward, venturing into unknown territories. During my campaign, I founded several cities, many of them named Alexandria, after myself. In Egypt, I was proclaimed Pharaoh, and it is there I founded the city of Alexandria, which remains a great metropolis to this day.

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Amr : King Alexander, thanks for being with us on this casual night to understand some of your great thoughts and contributions, and I would like to say that we know that conflict is a social phenomenon that occurs across species, time periods, and cultures. What thoughts can you give us?

Alexander : Good start Amr, our differences define our uniqueness – nationality, culture, gender, beliefs, values and our behaviors. From a very early age, we are aware of those differences, with siblings and peer groups.

We may have different abilities, talents, and levels of attractiveness or interest. Those differences define mankind, allow progress and contribute to the dynamics of the world. We are also aware that those differences contribute to conflict in our world. Each of us is likely to experience some degree of conflict, be it personal, professional, national or international.

Therefore, the very essence of being human contributes directly to the varying degrees of unhappiness, distress and destruction.

Amr : But what made Alexander, well… the Great?

Alexander : It's no secret, Amr, that without some form of discipline and self-control, you simply won't achieve your goals, and I had it because of my father, Philip of Macedonia. I was able to capitalize on this advantage to overwhelm armies that had sheer numbers of soldiers but no formation, no plan, and no discipline. It will get you a lot farther than motivation will.

Anything you want to do is done with and through people. If you don't know how to interact with your people, especially in a socially intelligent way, you will greatly lose out.

Amr, I was constantly getting my soldiers to buy into the vision of the better future that I promised them and all of Macedonia. You

have to be effective as a leader because you can inspire people to take action.

Amr : Sounds great, Alex; What else could we you teach us?

Alexander : Fine, first of all, if you want to be remembered as a great person, you have to have a great mentor and learn from him, as I learned from my mentor, Aristotle. I spent an unparalleled amount of time and money on training and development. I knew how to build a committed team and operated in a way that allowed my commanders to build on each other's strengths, and also looked to the future by developing the next generation.

Also, I knew how to encourage my troops for their excellence in battle by routinely singling out soldiers for special attention and recalling acts of bravery performed by individuals, making it clear that their contributions were recognized.

Amr : Can you tell us your leadership characteristics?

Alexander : Yes, indeed. I possessed a myriad of leadership characteristics that contributed to my success as a military commander and ruler, such as:

- **Visionary Leadership :**
    - A grand vision of uniting the known world under my rule. Ambition and foresight drove me to conquer vast territories and establish one of the largest empires in history.
- **Charisma :**
    - An undeniable charisma that inspired loyalty and devotion among my troops. Magnetic personality and ability to connect with people that helped me rally my soldiers and gain their unwavering support.

- **Strategic Genius :**
    - A brilliant military strategist who employed innovative tactics and maneuvers to outsmart the enemies, and demonstrated exceptional skill in adapting to different terrains and situations, enabling me to achieve victory against seemingly insurmountable odds.
- **Courage and Determination :**
    - I was fearless in the face of danger and displayed remarkable courage on the battlefield. My unwavering determination and willingness to lead from the front inspired my troops to follow me into battle with unwavering resolve.
- **Adaptability :**
    - The ability to adapt to changing circumstances and make quick decisions based on the evolving situation. The flexibility allowed me to overcome obstacles and navigate complex challenges throughout my conquests.
- **Strategic Communication :**
    - An effective communicator who could articulate my vision and inspire others to follow me. A skilled at rallying the troops with stirring speeches and maintaining morale during times of adversity.
- **Lead by Example :**
    - Led by example, demonstrating bravery, discipline, and dedication in my actions, and shared the hardships and risks faced by my soldiers, earning their respect and admiration.
- **Empathy and Respect for Diversity :**
    - Despite my military conquests, I showed a degree of empathy and respect for the cultures and beliefs of the peoples I encountered, and often integrated local customs and traditions into my administration, fostering a sense of unity among the diverse subjects.

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Amr : What strategy did you adopt during your invasions?

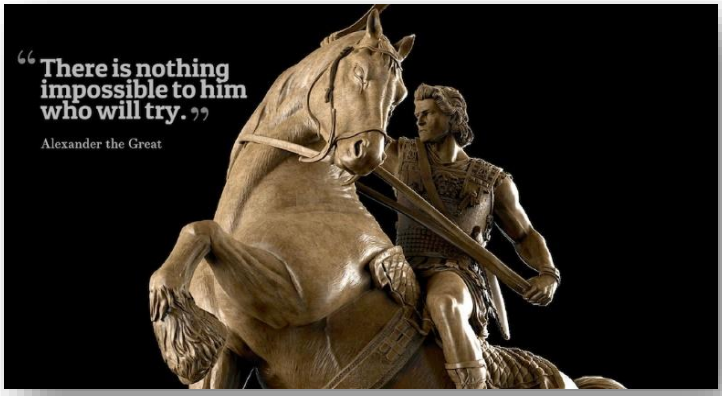
Alexander : In my conquests, I adopted a strategy of combining superior force with speed and strategic intelligence. I often employed tactics such as the phalanx formation and cavalry charges to quickly overwhelm enemy forces. Additionally,I utilized my knowledge of local terrain and cultures to outmaneuver and outsmart my opponents. Overall, my strategy was to strike swiftly and decisively to achieve victory and expand my empire.

Amr : Can you elaborate more for us?

Alexander : During my military campaigns, I employed a combination of strategies to achieve success. One of the key strategies I employed was the concept of a rapid and decisive offensive, known as the "hammer and anvil" tactic. This strategy involved utilizing well-trained cavalry forces, known as the Companion Cavalry, to deliver a powerful and swift strike against the enemy's weak points, while the rest of my forces acted as a supporting "anvil" to pin down and engage the enemy.

Another important aspect of my strategy was adaptability. I believed in studying and understanding the terrain, the strengths and weaknesses of my opponents, and adjusting my tactics accordingly. This allowed me to exploit any vulnerabilities and find innovative solutions to overcome obstacles.

I also placed great importance on integrating various cultures and military techniques into my own army. By incorporating the best practices from the civilizations I encountered, such as the phalanx formation of the Greeks or the archery skills of the Persians, I created a diverse and versatile fighting force that could adapt to different challenges on the battlefield.



Additionally, I sought to win the hearts and minds of the local populations in the territories I conquered. I often employed diplomacy and established alliances with local leaders to gain their support and cooperation. This approach helped to minimize resistance and maintain stability in the conquered regions.

Overall, my strategies focused on swift and decisive action, adaptability, integration of diverse military techniques, and engaging with local populations to ensure the success of my military campaigns.

Amr : Can your strategy be adopted it for modern organizations?

Alexander : Yes, many aspects of the strategies employed during my military campaigns can be adapted and applied to modern organizational settings.

Here are some ways in which the principles can be relevant:

- **Swift and Decisive Action :**
    - In today's fast-paced business world, the ability to make timely and decisive decisions is crucial. Organizations can benefit from adopting a proactive approach, identifying opportunities and challenges, and taking

swift action to seize opportunities or address issues before they escalate.

- **Adaptability :**
    - Just as I emphasized the importance of adjusting tactics based on the situation, modern organizations need to be adaptable in a rapidly changing business environment. This means being open to new ideas, embracing innovation, and being willing to adjust strategies and approaches as needed.
- **Integration and Learning :**
    - Similar to how I integrated diverse military techniques into my army, organizations can adopt a culture of learning and collaboration. This entails leveraging the strengths and talents of a diverse workforce, integrating best practices from different sources, and continuously seeking improvement and innovation.
- **Engaging Stakeholders :**
    - Building positive relationships with stakeholders, including customers, employees, and partners, is crucial for organizational success. Just as I sought the support and cooperation of local populations, modern organizations should focus on understanding and meeting the needs and expectations of their stakeholders, fostering trust, and maintaining positive relationships.
- **Strategy and Goal Alignment :**
    - Like I had a clear vision and goal of a unified empire, modern organizations need a well-defined strategy and clear goals. Aligning all levels of the organization towards these goals can help create a sense of purpose, motivation, and coordination.

It's important to note that while these principles can be adapted, the specific tactics and approaches will differ in the modern

organizational context. Each organization must assess its unique circumstances and tailor the strategies accordingly.

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Amr : Let us talk about your management style in managing the nation. What was your style?

Alexander : My leadership approach extended beyond military conquests to the management of the vast territories under my control. My management style is governing the empire:

- **Centralization of Power :**
  - I established a centralized government that allowed for efficient decision-making and administration. Key decisions were made at the top, often by me, or trusted advisers, while local administrators carried out the day-to-day governance of the regions.
- **Assimilation and Integration :**
  - Rather than imposing Greek culture or eradicating local customs and traditions, I sought to assimilate and integrate diverse cultures into the empire. This approach helped to foster a sense of unity and allowed for the preservation of local identities.
- **Local Autonomy :**
  - While central authority was maintained, I also recognized the importance of allowing regions some degree of self-governance. I appointed local leaders and respected their traditional systems of governance, as long as they remained loyal and contributed to the stability of the empire.
- **Infrastructure Development :**
  - I invested in extensive infrastructure projects, such as roads, bridges, and cities, to facilitate trade, communication, and the overall development of the

empire. This helped to integrate the various regions and enhance economic growth.

- **Promotion of Greek Culture :**
    - While respecting local cultures, I actively promoted Greek culture and language throughout the empire. This encouraged cultural exchange and facilitated communication among diverse groups.
- **Taxation and Economy :**
    - To finance the empire and its military endeavors, I implemented a system of taxation. However, I also aimed to balance this with economic growth by encouraging trade, fostering agricultural development, and capturing the wealth of conquered regions.
- **Administrative Reforms :**
    - I introduced administrative reforms to streamline governance, such as standardized weights and measures, and a common coinage system. This helped to facilitate economic exchange and administrative efficiency.

It's important to note that the specific management style adopted during my rule was influenced by the historical context and the unique challenges I faced.

Modern management styles in governing nations are shaped by different factors and considerations, such as democratic principles, human rights, and the rule of law.

Amr : Ok sounds great

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Amr : Finally, what advise can you give to current organizational leaders?

Alexander : As Alexander the Great, I would offer the following advice to current organizational leaders:

- **Lead by Example :** Leaders should set a positive example through their actions, work ethic, and values. Lead from the front, demonstrate integrity, and inspire others to excel.
- **Foster a Vision :** Develop a clear and compelling vision for your organization. Share this vision with your team and align their efforts towards achieving it. This will provide a sense of purpose and direction.
- **Empower and Delegate :** Trust your team members and empower them to make decisions and take ownership of their work. Delegate tasks according to their strengths and provide necessary support and guidance.
- **Communicate Effectively :** Establish open and transparent communication channels within the organization. Share information, provide feedback, and encourage dialogue. Effective communication builds trust, alignment, and cohesion.
- **Embrace Adaptability :** In today's rapidly changing business environment, being adaptable is crucial. Encourage a culture of innovation, agility, and continuous learning. Embrace change and encourage your team to think creatively and find innovative solutions.
- **Build Strong Relationships :** Fostering positive relationships with stakeholders, including employees, customers, and partners, is essential. Show empathy, listen to their needs, and build trust and mutually beneficial partnerships.
- **Invest in People :** Recognize that your greatest asset is your team. Invest in their development, provide opportunities for growth, and create a supportive and inclusive work environment. Nurture talent, encourage collaboration, and value diversity.

- **Embrace Challenges and Learn from Failure :** Challenges and setbacks are inevitable. Encourage a mindset of resilience and continuous improvement. Learn from failures, adapt strategies, and use setbacks as opportunities for growth.
- **Balance Short-Term Results with Long-Term Sustainability :** While achieving short-term goals is important, consider the long-term sustainability and impact of your decisions. Strive for a balance between profitability, social responsibility, and environmental considerations.
- **Lead with Compassion :** Show empathy and care for your team's well-being. Recognize and appreciate their efforts. A compassionate leader fosters a positive work culture, loyalty, and motivation.

Remember, leadership is a dynamic and continuous journey. Reflect on these principles, adapt them to your unique circumstances, and continue to evolve and grow as a leader.

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Amr : Thank you so much, Alexander the Great, and have a good evening.

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Mary P. Follett



Mary P. Follett, Mary Parker Follett (1868-1933), known as ***Mother of Management***, was an influential American social worker, management consultant, and pioneer in the fields of organizational theory and organizational behavior. She was born in Quincy, Massachusetts, to a wealthy Quaker family. Follett was educated at Radcliffe College and later studied philosophy and political science at Harvard University.

Who is Mary P. Follett?

Mary Parker Follett (1868-1933) is best known for her innovative ideas about conflict resolution, power dynamics, and the importance of collaboration in management.

Follett emphasized the importance of understanding and managing conflict within organizations, arguing that constructive conflict could lead to more effective decision-making and problem-solving. She also believed that power should be shared and distributed in organizations, rather than concentrated in the hands of a few individuals.

Follett's work laid the foundation for modern theories of management and organizational behavior, and her ideas continue to influence management practices today. She was a prolific writer and speaker, and her books and essays continue to be studied and cited in the fields of management, leadership, and organizational psychology.

Follett is best known for her work on democratic governance, conflict resolution, and management theory. Her ideas were ahead of her time and have had a lasting impact on management thought. Here are some key points about her life and work:

- **Social Work :**
    - Follett began her career as a social worker, working with various community organizations in Boston. She was particularly interested in issues of social reform and democracy.
- **Management Theory :**
    - Follett's most significant contributions came in the field of management theory. She developed a holistic approach to management that emphasized the importance of collaboration, integration, and the resolution of conflicts within organizations. She believed that power should be shared among all members of an organization, rather than concentrated in the hands of a few.
- **Democratic Governance :**
    - Follett was a strong advocate for democratic governance both within organizations and in society at large. She believed that decision-making should be decentralized and participatory, with input from all stakeholders.
- **Conflict Resolution :**
    - Follett's work on conflict resolution was groundbreaking. She believed that conflicts were not inherently destructive but could be opportunities for

growth and innovation if managed effectively. She developed techniques for resolving conflicts through negotiation, mediation, and collaboration.

Although Follett's work was not widely recognized during her lifetime, it has since gained recognition as a foundational contribution to the fields of management and organizational behavior. Her ideas have been influential in fields such as leadership studies, conflict resolution, and organizational development.

Mary Parker Follett's writings include books such as *The New State: Group Organization, the Solution for Popular Government* (1918) *and Creative Experience* (1924). Her ideas continue to be studied and applied by scholars and practitioners interested in creating more inclusive, democratic, and effective organizations.

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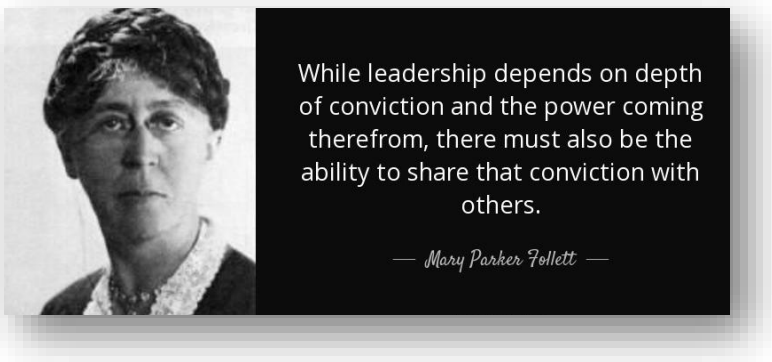
Amr : Mary, what a privilege to have you this night with us, and what an impressive background. So, can you tell us about some of your key contributions to management theory?

Mary : Certainly, one of my key contributions was my concept of integrative thinking, which emphasized resolving conflicts and finding solutions through collaboration and cooperation. I believed that power should be shared among all members of an organization, rather than centralized in a hierarchy. I also emphasized the importance of democratic leadership and the idea that individuals within an organization should work together as equals, rather than in a top-down manner.

Amr : How did your ideas and theories differ from traditional management practices of your time?

Mary : My ideas were quite radical for the early 20th century. At that time, most organizations operated under a strict hierarchical structure, with power and decision-making concentrated at the top. I challenged this traditional model by advocating for a more

inclusive and collaborative approach to management. I believed that individuals at all levels of an organization should have a say in decision-making and should work together to achieve common goals.



Amr : Your ideas seem quite progressive, especially considering the time in which you lived. How do you think your work has influenced modern management practices?

Mary : While my ideas were ahead of their time, I believe they have had a lasting impact on modern management theory and practice. Concepts such as conflict resolution, participative decision-making, and integrative thinking are now widely recognized as essential components of effective management. Moreover, the emphasis on human relations and the importance of fostering a supportive organizational culture resonates with contemporary approaches to leadership and organizational development.

Amr : Lastly, what advice do you have for modern managers looking to implement more collaborative and inclusive practices in their organizations?

Mary : My advice would be to embrace the concept of integrative thinking and to prioritize collaboration and cooperation among your

team members. Encourage open communication, empower individuals at all levels of the organization, and foster a culture of mutual respect and trust. By valuing the contributions of all team members and working together towards common goals, you can create a more inclusive and successful organization.

Building strong relationships based on trust and respect is essential for fostering collaboration and innovation. Remember, true leadership is not about asserting authority but about empowering others to achieve their full potential and collectively pursue organizational goals.

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Amr : What inspired you to investigate into the realm of organizational theory and management?

Mary : My interest in organizational theory stemmed from my background in social work and community organizing. I observed the dynamics of groups and communities closely and realized the importance of effective management in facilitating cooperation and progress. I was particularly drawn to the idea of integrating diverse perspectives and fostering collaboration within organizations.

Amr : Your work often emphasizes the significance of group dynamics and collaboration. Could you elaborate on how you believe these concepts contribute to effective management?

Mary : Certainly. I believe that effective management is not about exercising control over others but rather about facilitating harmonious relationships and collective decision-making. Understanding group dynamics allows managers to leverage the strengths of individuals and harness the collective intelligence of the group. Collaboration fosters innovation, enhances problem-solving capabilities, and cultivates a sense of ownership and commitment among employees.

Amr : Your ideas about power and authority in organizations have been quite influential. Can you elaborate on your concept of power with versus power over?

Mary : Absolutely. In traditional management practices, power is often perceived as hierarchical and coercive—a means of exerting control over others. However, I advocate for a more democratic approach to power, where it is distributed among individuals and exercised collaboratively. Power with entails shared decision-making, mutual respect, and cooperation, whereas power over relies on dominance and submission. By embracing power with, organizations can foster a culture of inclusivity, trust, and empowerment.

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Amr : Mary, can you share your definition of leadership and how it differs from management? And how can leaders balance the needs of individuals with the goals of the organization?

Mary : Certainly!

Definition of Leadership vs. Management :

I believed that while management focuses on administration, coordination, and control of resources to achieve specific outcomes, leadership is more about inspiring and guiding people towards a common purpose or vision.

Leadership is not confined to individuals with formal authority; it can emerge from any level of an organization. I emphasized that effective leadership involves fostering collaboration, facilitating dialogue, and encouraging participation among all stakeholders to achieve collective goals. In contrast, management often involves more structured processes, decision-making, and implementation of plans to ensure the efficient operation of the organization.

Balancing Individual Needs with Organizational Goals:

Leaders can balance the needs of individuals with the goals of the organization by promoting a collaborative approach to decision-making and problem-solving. I advocated for integrative unity, where conflicts between individual interests and organizational objectives are resolved through cooperation and mutual understanding rather than domination or compromise.

Leaders can create environment where individuals feel valued, heard, and empowered to contribute their unique perspectives while aligning their efforts towards the organization's broader mission and objectives.

I believe in the importance of recognizing the interdependence of individual and organizational goals, viewing them as complementary rather than conflicting. By fostering a culture of openness, trust, and inclusivity, leaders can encourage innovation, creativity, and commitment among employees while ensuring that their actions contribute to the overall success and sustainability of the organization.

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Amr : Thank you, Mrs. Follett, for sharing your insights with us. Your contributions to the field of management continue to inspire and guide us to this day.

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Salahuddin Ayyubi



Salahuddin Ayyubi was the founder of the Ayyubid dynasty. Hailing from a Kurdish family, he was the first sultan of both Egypt and Syria. An important figure of the Third Crusade, he spearheaded the Muslim military effort against the Crusader states in the Levant. At the height of his power, the Ayyubid realm spanned Egypt, Syria, Upper Mesopotamia, the Hejaz, Yemen, and Nubia[3].

Who is Salahuddin Ayyubi?

Salahuddin Ayyubi, also known as Saladin, was a prominent figure in Islamic history, particularly renowned for his role during the Crusades. Born in 1137 or 1138 in Tikrit, located in present-day Iraq, Salahuddin was of Kurdish ethnicity. He belonged to a family

[3] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Saladin

of soldiers, and his military prowess would shape much of his life. Founding the Ayyubid dynasty. His ascent to power came at a tumultuous time in the Middle East, marked by political fragmentation and the threat of Christian Crusaders from Europe, who aimed to reclaim the Holy Land from Muslim rule.

One of Salahuddin's most significant achievements was his recapture of Jerusalem from the Crusaders in 1187. This event is often considered his crowning achievement and a pivotal moment in the history of the Crusades. Salahuddin's reputation as a chivalrous and merciful leader was exemplified during the capture of Jerusalem, where he showed compassion and respect towards the defeated Christian inhabitants, in stark contrast to the brutal treatment often meted out by Crusader forces.

Salahuddin's military campaigns weren't solely focused on the Crusaders. He also faced internal threats and conflicts within the Muslim world, particularly from rival factions and the encroaching threat of the expanding Mongol Empire.

Despite facing numerous challenges, Salahuddin managed to consolidate power in the region and establish a stable and prosperous realm. His governance was characterized by tolerance towards religious minorities and a commitment to justice and fairness, earning him admiration even among his adversaries.

Salahuddin's legacy extends beyond his military exploits. He is remembered as a symbol of Islamic unity and resistance against foreign aggression. His reputation as a just and magnanimous ruler endures in both Islamic and Western historical accounts.

Salahuddin Ayyubi died in 1193 in Damascus, leaving behind a legacy that continues to inspire reverence and admiration in the modern era. His life and achievements have been celebrated in literature, art, and popular culture, cementing his status as one of the most iconic figures in medieval history.

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Amr : Good evening, Salahuddin Ayyubi. It's an honor to have the opportunity to speak with you. Your name is synonymous with valor, leadership, and chivalry. Let's begin with your early life. Can you tell us about your upbringing and what influenced your character and values?

Salahuddin : Thank you for having me.

My early life was marked by various experiences that shaped my character. I was born in Tikrit, Iraq, in 1137 AD, into a Kurdish family with a military background. My father, Najm ad-Din Ayyub, served as a military commander under the Zengid dynasty. Growing up, I was exposed to the values of courage, discipline, and loyalty through my family and the military environment.

Amr : Your reputation as a just ruler is also well-documented. How did you manage to govern such a diverse and vast territory while maintaining justice and order?

Salahuddin : Governance was a complex task, but I adhered to certain principles that guided my rule. I believed in justice for all, regardless of their background or religion. I appointed capable administrators who were fair and just in their dealings. I also implemented policies to promote religious tolerance and coexistence among different communities. Additionally, I prioritized the welfare of my subjects, investing in infrastructure, education, and healthcare to improve their quality of life.

Amr : Your leadership has inspired countless individuals throughout history. What advice would you give to leaders today, facing their own challenges in a rapidly changing world?

Salahuddin : Leadership is about integrity, vision, and empathy. Leaders should lead by example, embodying the values they espouse. They must have a clear vision for the future and the ability to adapt to changing circumstances. Empathy towards the concerns

and aspirations of their people is essential for fostering trust and cooperation. Furthermore, leaders should prioritize the common good over personal interests and work towards building a more just and equitable society.

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Amr : Salahuddin, how do you select your leaders, and what criteria do you use in the selection process?

Salahuddin : In selecting leaders, I believe it is important to consider a number of qualities and characteristics. Firstly, I look for individuals who possess strong leadership skills, including the ability to motivate and inspire others, make difficult decisions, and effectively communicate with their team.

Additionally, I value integrity, honesty, and humility in a leader. It is essential that they act with honor and stick to their principles, even when faced with adversity. I also consider their track record of performance and their commitment to the goals and values of our organization. Moreover, I believe that diversity in leadership is important. I strive to have a team that represents a variety of perspectives and backgrounds, as this leads to more well-rounded decision-making and fosters creativity and innovation.

Overall, my selection criteria for leaders include leadership skills, integrity, performance, commitment, and diversity. I believe that by choosing leaders who embody these qualities, we can build a strong and successful team that can achieve our goals and fulfill our mission.

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Amr : I'd like to explore your approach to decision-making, if I may. Could you share with us how you typically approached making important decisions during your reign?

Salahuddin : Decision-making during my rule was a matter of great responsibility and careful consideration. There were several principles I adhered to when faced with significant choices.

Firstly, consultation was paramount. I believed in seeking the counsel of trusted advisors, scholars, and experienced individuals before reaching a conclusion. This allowed me to gather diverse perspectives and weigh the pros and cons of each option thoroughly.

Secondly, I placed great emphasis on gathering accurate information. Before making any decision, I ensured that I had a comprehensive understanding of the situation at hand. This involved gathering intelligence, assessing the capabilities of my own forces, as well as those of my adversaries.

Thirdly, I considered the long-term implications of my decisions. While it's essential to address immediate concerns, I always endeavored to think ahead and anticipate the potential consequences of my actions on the stability and welfare of my realm.

Fourthly, I valued pragmatism and flexibility. Circumstances on the battlefield and in politics can change rapidly, so I remained adaptable and open to adjusting my strategies as needed.

Lastly, I sought guidance from my faith. As a devout Muslim, I turned to prayer and reflection for spiritual guidance and strength during challenging times. My faith provided me with a moral compass and a sense of purpose that influenced my decision-making process.

In summary, my approach to decision-making was grounded in consultation, information gathering, long-term thinking, adaptability, and faith. These principles guided me in navigating the complexities of ruling during a tumultuous period in history.

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Amr : And how did you handle decision disagreement?

Salahuddin : During my leadership, I always tried to listen to the advice and opinions of my advisors and generals before making a decision. However, there were times when we disagreed on certain matters. In such cases, I would carefully consider all perspectives and weigh the pros and cons of each option.

Ultimately, I would make a decision based on what I believed was best for the success of our mission and the well-being of our people. I always strove to lead by example and inspire confidence in my followers, even in the face of disagreement. This approach helped us navigate challenges effectively and achieve many victories in battle.

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Amr : Thank you, Salahuddin, for sharing your insights with us. Your legacy continues to inspire generations, and your principles of justice and leadership remain timeless.

Salahuddin : It has been my pleasure, Amr, and I hope that my experiences can serve as a source of inspiration for leaders striving to make a positive impact in the world. Thank you for the opportunity to share my story.

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Attila The Hun



Attila the Hun was a powerful and fearsome ruler who reigned over the Hunnic Empire in the 5th century. He is often referred to as the "Scourge of God" due to his ruthless conquests and brutal warfare tactics. Attila led his armies on campaigns across Europe, terrorizing and pillaging cities and kingdoms along the way. He famously invaded the Eastern Roman Empire and Western Roman Empire, causing widespread destruction and chaos. Attila's empire eventually crumbled after his death in 453 AD, but his legacy as a formidable and brutal warrior king still lives on in history.

Who is Attila?

Attila the Hun, often referred to simply as Attila, was one of the most fearsome and notorious leaders of ancient history. He was born around 406 AD, the son of Mundzuk, who was the brother of the Hunnic ruler Octar. Attila and his brother Bleda rose to power in the Hunnic Empire after the death of their uncle, Octar, in 434 AD.

Under Attila's leadership, the Hunnic Empire expanded its territory significantly, becoming a major power in Europe during the 5th century AD. Attila was known for his military prowess and his ability to unite the various Hunnic tribes under his rule. He was also a skilled diplomat, forging alliances when it suited his purposes and ruthlessly crushing any opposition.

Attila's most famous campaign was his invasion of the Western Roman Empire. In 451 AD, he launched a massive assault on Gaul (modern-day France), but was defeated by a combined Roman and Visigothic force at the Battle of the Catalaunian Plains. Despite this setback, Attila continued to raid Roman territories and exact tribute from the Roman Emperor.

In 452 AD, Attila launched another invasion, this time into Italy. He marched his army to the gates of Rome itself, but ultimately withdrew after negotiating a hefty ransom from the Roman Emperor Valentinian III.

Attila's reign came to an end in 453 AD, when he died under mysterious circumstances on his wedding night. Some sources suggest that he may have suffered a nosebleed and choked to death, while others claim that he was murdered by his new bride. Regardless of the cause, Attila's death marked the end of an era for the Huns, and their empire quickly disintegrated in the years following his demise.

Attila's legacy as a fearsome warrior and ruthless conqueror has endured throughout history. He is often remembered as the "Scourge of God" and has been depicted in various works of literature, art, and film as a symbol of barbarian ferocity and the collapse of the Roman Empire.

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Amr : Attila, thank you for taking the time to speak with me today, your legacy is one of the most iconic figures in history endures.

“As one of history's most renowned leaders, your name is synonymous with power and conquest. Can you tell us about your approach to leadership and how you managed to command such loyalty and obedience from your followers?"

Attila : Amr, it is my pleasure to speak with you. Leadership, to me, is about strength, vision, and the ability to inspire loyalty. I believe in leading by example and demonstrating unwavering resolve in the face of challenges. My leadership style is built upon principles of decisiveness and fearlessness. When my men see that I am unyielding in my pursuit of our goals, they are more inclined to follow suit.

Amr : Many leaders throughout history have faced opposition and internal dissent. How did you maintain control over such a vast empire, and what strategies did you employ to ensure loyalty among your subjects?

Attila : Control and loyalty are paramount in maintaining a vast empire. I understood the importance of instilling fear in those who dared to oppose us, but I also recognized the value of rewarding loyalty. I surrounded myself with trusted advisors and generals who shared my vision and rewarded them generously for their loyalty and service. Additionally, I made examples of those who dared to betray or defy me, sending a clear message that disloyalty would not be tolerated.

Amr : Your conquests and military campaigns are legendary. What role did strategic planning play in your leadership, and how did you ensure victory on the battlefield?

Attila : Strategic planning was essential to our success on the battlefield. I meticulously planned each campaign, taking into account factors such as terrain, enemy strengths and weaknesses, and logistical considerations. I also employed tactics such as

surprise attacks and psychological warfare to demoralize and intimidate our enemies.

However, victory was not solely reliant on military prowess; diplomacy also played a crucial role. I forged alliances when necessary and used diplomacy to divide and conquer my enemies.

Amr : In modern times, leadership is often associated with values such as empathy, inclusivity, and collaboration. How do you reconcile the stark contrast between your leadership style and contemporary leadership ideals?

Attila : While the ideals of leadership may have evolved over time, the fundamental principles remain the same. Leadership is about achieving results and inspiring others to follow you. In my time, strength and dominance were valued above all else, but the essence of leadership – the ability to rally others towards a common goal – remains unchanged. Ultimately, leadership is contextual, and what may be effective in one era or culture may not necessarily translate to another.

Amr : Thank you, Attila, for sharing your insights into leadership with us today. Your legacy as a formidable leader continues to captivate and inspire people to this day.

Attila : It has been my pleasure. Remember, true leadership is forged in the fires of adversity and tested on the battlefield of history.

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Augustus



Who is Augustus?

Before the world knew emperors, there was **Augustus**.

Born as *Gaius Octavius*, he rose from relative obscurity to become the first emperor of Rome after the collapse of the Roman Republic. Through political mastery, strategic alliances, and calculated restraint, Augustus established a new order—one that preserved the outward form of a republic while consolidating unprecedented authority in a single ruler.

His reign (27 BCE – 14 CE) ushered in the **Pax Romana**, a period of stability and prosperity lasting over two centuries. Yet, beyond military victories and political reforms, Augustus faced a challenge few had encountered before:

How do you pass power in a system that was never designed for succession?

What follows is a deeply reflective dialogue exploring how Augustus approached succession planning with strategic foresight, discipline, and realism.

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Amr : Augustus, thank you for joining me on this final evening. Your legacy stands as one of the most enduring and influential in history.

Augustus, history remembers you as the founder of an empire. But today, we focus on something less visible—your approach to succession. When did you first realize it would be a defining challenge?

Augustus : The moment I secured power, I understood its greatest threat was not opposition—it was uncertainty after me.

Rome had no blueprint for succession. Kings were rejected, dictators were feared, and yet the state demanded continuity. I realized then:

If I failed to plan my succession, I would undo my own achievements.

So, succession was not an afterthought.

It was central to governance.

Many leaders treat succession as a final act. I treated it as a **continuous responsibility**. From early in my rule, I began observing, testing, and positioning potential successors.

Amr : Augustus, let me say that you relied heavily on adoption rather than direct inheritance. Why?

Augustus : Because leadership is not a matter of birth—it is a matter of **fitness**.

Adoption gave me flexibility. It allowed me to:

- Select individuals with capability
- Legitimize them within Roman law

- Introduce them gradually to power

In your modern language, it was a form of **strategic talent selection**.

Amr : Your early successors, Gaius and Lucius, did not ultimately succeed you. How did that affect your strategy?

Augustus : It forced me to confront a difficult truth: **Even the most carefully chosen successors are subject to forces beyond control.**

Their loss taught me to:

- Avoid over-reliance on a single candidate
- Maintain multiple succession pathways
- Continuously reassess readiness

Succession is not a plan—it is a **dynamic system**.

Amr : Eventually, you chose Tiberius. Was he your ideal successor?

Augustus : He was not my first choice—but he was the **right choice**.

Tiberius possessed discipline, experience, and the respect of the army. He lacked charm, perhaps—but empires are not sustained by charm.

Leadership, at its core, is about **stability under pressure**.

Amr : You gradually elevated Tiberius before your death. Why was that important?

Augustus : Yes Amr, because power must be **seen to be transferred before it is fully transferred**.

I ensured he:

- Held significant authority alongside me
- Led military campaigns

- Became familiar to the Senate and the people

By the time I was gone, Rome had already accepted him.

Amr : What role did stakeholders play in your succession planning?

Augustus : A decisive one.

A successor unsupported by the Senate, the army, or the people is no successor at all.

I did not impose succession—I **orchestrated acceptance**.

Amr : Many leaders today struggle with letting go. Did you?

Augustus : Naturally.

Power shape's identity. To release it is to confront one's own impermanence.

But I understood this: **A leader who refuses to let go does not extend his legacy—he shortens it.**

Amr : Looking back, what was your greatest success in succession planning?

Augustus : That Rome did not collapse when I died.

Continuity is the ultimate test of leadership. If everything depends on one individual, then nothing truly endures.

Amr : And your greatest mistake?

Augustus : Perhaps that I learned too late the importance of **institutional strength over personal preference**.

I initially sought a successor I favored. In the end, I chose the one the system could sustain.

Amr : If you were advising modern executives and leaders, what would you tell them?

Augustus : Five principles:

1. **Begin succession early :**
   It is a long-term investment, not a last-minute decision.
2. **Develop multiple leaders :**
   One successor is a risk; several are resilience.
3. **Test capability in reality :**
   Titles do not reveal leadership—circumstances do
4. **Build legitimacy before transition :**
   Authority must be accepted before it is exercised
5. **Separate ego from institution :**
   You are temporary. The institution must not be.

Leadership is not defined by the power one accumulates, but by the continuity one secures.

Amr : Thank you, Augustus, for your valuable conversation and being with me.

This interview is a constructed historical dialogue inspired by primary Roman sources and modern leadership literature. While the dialogue is fictionalized, it reflects historically grounded interpretations of Augustus' approach to governance and succession.

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Conclusions

In essence, the traditional concept of an executive as solely command-and-control-driven is outdated. In today's dynamic business landscape, the sheer pace of change across multiple fronts means no individual can fully grasp and oversee every aspect. With this antiquated executive approach, organizational progress is hampered, and the myriad challenges it confronts remain unaddressed.

Leaders Vs. Managers

A small step forward is the executive who empowers people and then solves problems as they arise. Most executives enjoy solving problems; it feels good to get something tangible done. But solving problems is not enough. Executives cannot afford to work example-by-example. If they focus on today's problems, they'll be too busy to figure out how to prevent future problems (which, it seems, can always be postponed). Worse, they may become too close to the problems to see the forest for the trees.

In addition to solving problems, executives must fix the organization so that similar problems do not recur, or at least do not rise to the executives' level.

Of course, there are times when executives must step into the day-to-day operations and fix a severe problem. But executives can never have enough time to solve every new problem. And executives who repeatedly rescue the situation, and do no more, inevitably institutionalize their organizations' dependence on them.

Executives must also supervise people; a day-to-day task. Growing good people has a tremendous impact. But as important as it is, coaching individuals is painfully slow as a channel for change.

The problem with firefighting and people management is the lack of leverage. It may be fun to make tough decisions and lead the charge on critical projects. But those place far too much emphasis on only one mind: the executives.

The most effective executives tap all the bright minds in their organizations rather than depend solely on the one at the top. Effective executives empower people at every level while guiding them toward individual excellence and high-performance teamwork.

The most important job of an executive is to design an organization in which everyone can succeed. This captures the essence of the word leadership — in contrast to an executive's managerial duties. The managerial portion of the job is the time spent supervising people and doing the day-to-day work of the organization. The leadership portion is the time executives spend improving the way their organizations operate.

Managers supervise people and do the day-to-day work of organizations.
Leaders improve the way organizations do their day-to-day work.

Managers develop strategic plans that deal with the issues of the day. Leaders develop meta-plans that grow healthy organizations capable of dealing with the myriad strategic issues of today and tomorrow.

Managers envision the future of the business. Leaders envision organizations that will deal with whatever the future may bring. Managers fight alligators. Leaders drain the swamp.

Leader	Manager
Visionary: A leader sets the vision and direction for the team or organization. **Inspires and Motivates:** Leaders inspire and motivate their team members to achieve their goals. **Focuses on People:** Leaders prioritize the development and well-being of their team members. **Innovates:** Leaders encourage innovation and creativity within their team or organization. **Takes Risks:** Leaders are willing to take calculated risks to achieve their vision. **Builds Relationships:** Leaders focus on building strong relationships with their team members and stakeholders. **Leads by Example:** Leaders lead by example, demonstrating the values and behaviors they expect from others.	**Plans and Organizes:** Managers are responsible for planning and organizing the work of the team to achieve specific goals. **Executes:** Managers ensure that tasks are completed efficiently and effectively according to the plan. **Focuses on Tasks:** Managers prioritize the accomplishment of tasks and meeting deadlines. **Controls:** Managers monitor progress and ensure that resources are allocated appropriately. **Mitigates Risks:** Managers identify and mitigate risks to ensure the smooth operation of the team or organization. **Coordinates:** Managers coordinate the efforts of team members to achieve common objectives. **Implements Policies:** Managers implement policies and procedures set by higher levels of authority.

While leaders and managers have different roles and responsibilities, it's important to note that effective leadership often incorporates elements of both. In many situations, individuals may need to fulfill both leadership and management roles to succeed in guiding their team or organization toward its goals.

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To illustrate the difference between managers and leaders, imagine that you are concerned about your organization's lack of partnership with clients. You would like people to focus on clients' strategies rather than just on traditional operational issues. You determine that there are three key activities that will make or break the strategic value of your organization: opportunity identification, clients' priority setting, and project delivery.

- **Opportunity identification :** While it may be tempting for you to personally work with client executives to identify their strategic needs, it would not be good leadership. Your organization would be limited to the few strategic projects that you can find in the little time you can afford to spend with individual clients.
  As a leader, you might introduce methods to identify clients' strategic opportunities, then let the organization find them day after day. When the organization continually works to ensure alignment, the result is an avalanche of projects well focused on the unique strategic needs of each client.
- **Priority setting :** An organization's bottom-line value to clients is directly related to its priority-setting processes. If it pursues low-payoff projects, there is little staff can do to align their efforts with clients' strategies.

Within a company, a service department's executive may feel well qualified to determine project priorities on behalf of the company, perhaps with the help of an advisory committee. Typically, such committees meet for a few hours each quarter, and don't have time

to understand the hundreds of creative ideas generated throughout, the company some of which cannot afford to wait months for a priority decision.

As a result, hot strategic projects may not get done. Or worse, priorities are set once a year in a strategic plan, and the organization becomes unresponsive to changes in the business throughout the year.

A leader, on the other hand, designs processes whereby clients dynamically adjust priorities throughout the year. As a result, clients are in control of their purchases; decisions are based on clients' much better understanding of their unique business needs; and priorities can shift as quickly as the business environment changes.

Similarly, vendors which help their clients become smart buyers of their products and understand the relative returns on various investments will deliver more value to their clients' bottom line than those which simply take orders.

- **Project delivery :** In the past, the boss formed project teams and supervised their work. However, in a dynamic organization, dozens of projects are initiated each month. Each requires a unique mix of skills and a unique sequence of activities. The boss may not understand exactly what skills are needed when and, without the right talent on each team, productivity will suffer.

Business process reengineering, while it may be a step forward, is still not leadership. Executives who reengineer the product-delivery process, for example, are working at the level of a super-project manager. They may design a work flow that is optimal in some cases, but it is bound to be inappropriate in others. Meanwhile, the flexibility of their organizations suffers.

Dynamic Organization Need Dynamic Leader

To prosper in challenging times, organizations must be dynamic. They must innovate, align themselves with diverse clients' strategies and market opportunities, improve internal processes for project delivery and operations, and integrate their products. And they must do all these things simultaneously (not one at a time as special projects), and do them all continually not once a year as part of an annual plan or occasionally when executives initiate task forces.

Executives who try to personally coordinate and control everything are destined to fail (and are likely candidates for ulcers as well). The proper role for an executive is that of leader, not foreman — one who focuses on issues of governance rather than projects and crises.

When problems arise, an executive must solve them. But the true leader doesn't stop there. He or she asks, why did this problem rise to my level in the first place? And how can we fix the root cause so the problem doesn't happen again?

Focusing on systemic change gives an executive the leverage he or she needs to handle the tremendous pace and complexity of today's business challenges. By consciously designing the organizational environment that guides everybody in every aspect of their work, a leader can subtly influence every decision, every day -- without disempowering and micro-managing people.

Through systemic change, leaders can build healthy, high-performance organizations that succeed — with or without them.

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A leader focuses on the meta-processes by which everybody forms teams across organizational boundaries and everybody determines the appropriate project-management processes. These meta-

processes ensure that people throughout the organization assemble just the right people at just the right time to make just the right contributions.

Meta-processes also let each team tailor its work flow to fit the project's unique needs, and ensure that each team member has clear accountabilities.

In summary, managers focus on results, and do so day after day. Leaders focus on the organizational processes that enable everybody to produce results forevermore. Working at the leadership level leverages executives' time, and reduces the risk of executive bottlenecks.

Thus, it’s up to you to decide whether to be a Leader or a Manager!

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